



Harbourside
Community Trust

Harbourside Community Trust brand guidelines

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Introduction

Harbourside Community Trust exists to help families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods find safe homes, warm meals and good work. People trust us when everything we make looks, sounds and feels the same: a poster in a community centre, a WhatsApp message to a volunteer, a letter to a family or a report for the council. This guide shows you how to make that happen.

Who this guide is for

This guide is for everyone who makes something with our name on it:

- **Staff and volunteers** writing posts, posters, letters, emails and signs.
- **The Communications team**, who look after the brand day to day.
- **Designers, printers, web developers and agencies** we work with.
- **Partners and funders**, including the council, who show our logo next to theirs.

You do not need to be a designer to use it. Most chapters start with the reason for a rule, then give the rule, then show a **Do** and a **Don't**.

How to use this guide

1. **Start with the basics.** Read *Brand foundations*, *Logo*, *Colour*, *Typography* and *Voice and tone*. They cover most everyday work.
2. **Go to the chapter for your job.** Making a social post? Go to *Social media*. Writing a letter to families? Go to *Writing style* and *Presentations and documents*.
3. **Use the ready-made files.** Logos, social templates, favicons and design tokens are in the asset kit listed in *Legal, governance and assets*. Starting from these files is faster and keeps you on-brand.
4. **Check accessibility before you publish.** Use the checklist in *Accessibility*.

What is fixed and what is flexible

Fixed: always follow	Flexible: use your judgement
The logo artwork, its colours, clear space and minimum size	Which approved logo version suits the background
Brand colour values and the approved colour pairings	How much of each brand colour a layout uses, within the proportions
Accessibility rules: contrast, text size, alt text, captions	Photography subjects and crops, within the imagery rules
Our name, written as <i>Harbourside Community Trust</i>	Tone, which shifts with the situation (see <i>Voice and tone</i>)
Consent rules for photos and stories about people we help	Layout, as long as it uses the grid and spacing scale

If a rule stops you doing something sensible, talk to the Communications team before you break it. We would rather improve the guide than have people work around it.

Our accessibility commitment

Many of the people we serve are older, live with a disability, or speak English as a second language. So accessibility is not an extra in this guide: it is built into every rule. Everything we publish must meet WCAG 2.2 level AA as a minimum. That means readable text sizes, strong colour contrast, plain English, alt text on images, captions on video, and an offline or phone route to help for anyone who cannot use digital channels. The *Accessibility* chapter explains how.

Getting help

Questions about the brand, requests for logo files, or approval of a new design go to the Communications team at comms@harbourside.example. Please allow at least five working days for approvals; *Legal, governance and assets* sets out the approval process.

- Do start from the templates and logo files in the asset kit.
- Don't redraw, retype or recolour the logo, or copy it from a website or a screenshot.
- Note** Parts of this guide are proposals, such as our vision, tagline, colour names and fonts. They are marked as proposals until our leadership confirms them.

About this guide

Item	Detail
Organisation	Harbourside Community Trust
Guide version	1.0.0
Last updated	2026-10-02
Brand owner	Communications team
Contact	comms@harbourside.example
Accessibility standard	WCAG 2.2 AA
Language and spelling	en-GB
Review cadence	Every 12 months, and after any rebrand or platform change

Assumptions to confirm:

- Brand colours were extracted from the logo; confirm exact values against the master artwork or existing specifications.
- CMYK values are mathematical conversions; confirm with your printer and choose Pantone matches from a physical swatch book.
- Social platform specifications were last reviewed on the date in the social chapter; verify before production.
- Non-interactive run: no questions were asked. Defaults below were chosen by the brand team and need confirmation.
- Colour names (Harbour Blue, Sunset Coral, Tide Blue) were proposed by us; confirm or rename.
- The circular sun-and-waves symbol was cropped from the master logo to assets/source/symbol.png for avatars and favicons; a designer should confirm it or supply vector artwork.
- The logo was supplied only as a PNG (1289x400). Vector (SVG/EPS/PDF) master artwork should be sourced for print and signage.
- Fonts proposed: Nunito (display, matches the rounded wordmark) and Atkinson Hyperlegible Next (body, chosen for older and low-vision readers); both free under the SIL Open Font License. The typeface used in the logo itself has not been identified.
- Minimum logo size raised to 160px / 40mm so the smaller 'Community Trust' line stays legible; confirm with a designer.
- Corner radius increased to match the rounded letterforms and circular symbol.
- Social handles were not supplied; none are listed.
- Vision, positioning, tagline, personality, value descriptions and boilerplate are proposals built from the supplied mission and values; confirm with trustees/leadership.
- The organisation's legal status (e.g. registered charity number) was not supplied; the legal chapter uses placeholders.

- Single-colour logos use the knockout style (sun and waves cut out) because the plain style loses all symbol detail; the Tide Blue band merges into the surrounding shape. Official single-colour artwork should be confirmed by a designer.
- The full-colour logo is approved on white as the master presentation, although 'Community Trust' in Sunset Coral is 2.95:1 on white. Logotypes are exempt from WCAG contrast; this exception needs sign-off from the Communications team, and the logo must never be the only place the name appears.
- Brand hashtags #HereForHarbourside and #HarboursideTrust are proposals; check they are not in use by others. Proposed handle pattern: HarboursideTrust.
- House style: -ise spelling, no serial comma by default, single quotation marks, 'the Trust' as the short name, no 'HCT' in public content. Reading age 9-11 for public content, 12-14 for partner documents.
- Print body text: 14pt minimum for public materials, 12pt for partner/internal reports, 16pt+ for large print; 44x44px targets everywhere. These are stricter than WCAG AA because of the audience.
- Charities are usually outside the Public Sector Bodies Accessibility Regulations 2018; trustees should confirm whether funding or contracts bring the Trust into scope.
- Chart series order, mobile type sizes, the wave-line divider, the logo sting animation, Lucide icons and a two-year consent review are proposals.
- Approval lead times, response times, posting rhythms, embroidery minimums and the Word/PowerPoint/Google templates are proposals; the templates do not yet exist.
- Community languages for translation, a phone number, registered address and charity number were not supplied and appear as placeholders.

Brand foundations

Everything we design or write starts here. When you know what we do, who we do it for and how we behave, you can make good choices in any situation this guide does not cover.

Some parts of this chapter were given to us by Harbourside Community Trust: the mission and the four value names. Everything else is a proposal from the brand team and is marked *Proposed — confirm with leadership*. Do not publish proposed wording outside the organisation until leadership has approved it.

Mission

The mission says what we do, for whom and why. Use it word for word.

We help families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods find safe homes, warm meals and good work.

Three ideas sit inside the mission. Keep them in this order and in these words when you summarise our work:

- **Safe homes**
- **Warm meals**
- **Good work**

Don't add services, numbers or results to the mission. If you need to describe a specific service, check the facts with the Communications team first.

Vision

Proposed — confirm with leadership: "A Harbourside where every family has a safe home, enough to eat and work they can be proud of."

The vision is the future we are working towards. It is not a promise or a claim about results. Use it in strategy documents, annual reviews and talks, not in short social posts.

Positioning

Proposed — confirm with leadership: "For families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods who need help with a home, food or work, Harbourside Community Trust is the local charity that helps them find all three in one place, because we are part of the community we serve and we work alongside neighbours, volunteers and partners."

The positioning is for internal use. It helps you decide what to say first. It is not a public slogan.

Note "In one place" and "part of the community" are claims. Leadership must confirm both are true before we use them in public copy.

Values

The four value names come from the organisation. Use them exactly as written, with a capital letter, in this order. The descriptions and behaviours are proposals.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: descriptions and behaviours for each value.

Value	What it means	How it shows in our words
Kindness	We treat everyone with warmth, patience and respect.	We write as a friendly neighbour would speak: warm, calm and never judging.
Fairness	Everyone deserves the same chance and the same respect.	We describe people with dignity, explain rules clearly and never hide the small print.
Together	We do more when families, volunteers, donors and partners work side by side.	We say "with", not "for". We credit volunteers and partners by name when they agree.
Local first	We belong to Harbourside and put local people and places first.	We name real streets, places and local partners, and we write for the people who live here.

Do show a value through behaviour: "Our volunteers will meet you at the door and help you fill in the form."

Don't list our values as adjectives in a sentence such as "We are kind, fair and local." Show them instead.

Brand personality

Proposed — confirm with leadership: our personality comes from the logo: a rising sun over calm waves, rounded letters and warm colour. If Harbourside Community Trust were a person, they would be:

Trait	What it means	Links to voice attribute (chapter 11)
Warm	Friendly and kind, like a neighbour at the door	Warm, not sentimental
Steady	Calm and reliable, even when things are hard	Calm and steady, not cold
Approachable	Easy to talk to; no jargon, no barriers	Clear and simple, not childish
Hopeful	Looks towards better days, like the rising sun	Hopeful and honest, not over-promising
Rooted	Proud to be from Harbourside and the coast	Rooted in Harbourside, not parochial

We are not corporate, and we are not playful in a childish way. We are the steady, friendly people you are glad to see.

Audiences

Our audiences were supplied by the organisation. Their needs and channels below are *Proposed* — *confirm with leadership*, based on the audience list and the platforms we use (Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, LinkedIn and our website).

Many of our readers are older residents, and many speak English as a second language. Write every message so that both groups can understand it the first time they read it.

Audience	What they need from us	Main channels	Plan for
Local families	Clear, kind information about what help is available, who can get it, where to go and what to bring. Respect and privacy.	WhatsApp, Facebook, website, printed leaflets and posters	Plain English, short sentences, translations, Easy Read versions, information that works on a basic phone and offline
Volunteers	What to do, when and where; how their time helps; thanks and recognition.	WhatsApp, Facebook, email, website	Clear shift details, simple sign-up steps, mixed ages and levels of digital confidence
Donors	Honest information about where their money goes, and simple ways to give.	Website, Facebook, Instagram, email, LinkedIn	No guilt or pressure, clear consent choices, accessible donation forms
Council partners	Reliable facts, clear contacts and evidence of local need, presented professionally.	Email, LinkedIn, reports and documents	Accessible documents (tagged PDF or Word), defined terms, no unsupported claims
Older residents	Large, clear text, simple steps and a phone number or place to visit.	Printed materials, phone, Facebook, face to face	At least 16px on screen and 14pt in print, no "online only" routes, no small grey text
People who speak English as a second language	Short, literal sentences they can read or translate easily.	WhatsApp, Facebook, printed materials	No idioms, consistent words, translated versions where possible, simple icons with text

Accessibility Always give at least one way to get help that does not need the internet, such as a phone number or an address with opening times.

Tagline

Proposed — confirm with leadership: "Here for Harbourside."

It is short, literal and easy to translate. It works next to the logo, at the end of a video and as a sign-off on social posts.

Use the tagline in sentence case with a full stop when it stands alone. Never change its words or add a second line to it.

Boilerplate

Use these "About us" texts at the end of press releases, on partner websites, in event programmes and in funding applications. Choose the length that fits the space. Do not edit them, except to update approved facts.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: all three versions below.

Short (about 25 words)

Harbourside Community Trust is a local charity. We help families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods find safe homes, warm meals and good work. Contact comms@harbourside.example.

Medium (about 50 words)

Harbourside Community Trust is a local charity. We help families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods find safe homes, warm meals and good work. We work with local families, volunteers, donors and council partners. Our values are Kindness, Fairness, Together and Local first. To find out more, email comms@harbourside.example.

Long (about 100 words)

Harbourside Community Trust is a local charity. We help families in Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods find safe homes, warm meals and good work.

We believe every family deserves a safe place to live, enough to eat and the chance of a good job. We work side by side with local families, volunteers, donors and council partners, because we can do more together.

Our values guide everything we do: Kindness, Fairness, Together and Local first. We treat everyone with respect, and we put Harbourside's people and places first.

To volunteer, give or work with us, email comms@harbourside.example.

Warning Add the registered charity number to the boilerplate only when the organisation has confirmed it. Never guess or copy a number from another source.

Logo

Our logo is the quickest way people recognise us: on a food bank poster, a WhatsApp message from a volunteer or a council partner's report. Using it the same way every time builds trust with families who may be meeting us at a hard moment, so treat it as fixed artwork and follow these rules.

Our logo

The logo is a **combination mark**: a circular symbol on the left and the name, set as a wordmark, on the right.

The symbol shows a Sunset Coral half-sun rising over three white wave lines inside a solid Harbour Blue circle, with a Tide Blue band between the lower waves. It describes where we work: Harbourside's coastal neighbourhoods. The rising sun is warm and hopeful, and the waves are calm rather than stormy. The heavy, rounded letters of "Harbourside" feel friendly and steady, not corporate.

Those cues of round shapes, soft curves, warm colour and heavy, approachable letters run through the whole identity. They are why our corners are rounded (chapter 06), our icons have rounded ends (chapter 07) and our display typeface has soft terminals (chapter 05).

Anatomy

Part	What it is	Notes
Symbol	The Harbour Blue circle containing the sun, the waves and the Tide Blue band	Can be used on its own in square and circular spaces
Wordmark, line 1	"Harbourside" in a heavy rounded sans-serif, Harbour Blue	The dominant part of the name
Wordmark, line 2	"Community Trust" in a lighter weight, Sunset Coral	Smallest detail in the logo: this sets the minimum size
Lock-up	The fixed size and spacing between symbol and wordmark	Never change it

The white wave lines break through the edge of the circle. That is part of the drawing, not a printing fault, so never "tidy" it by redrawing the circle.

Versions and when to use each



Original logo file as supplied



primary logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)



primary logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)



primary logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)



primary logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)



primary logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)



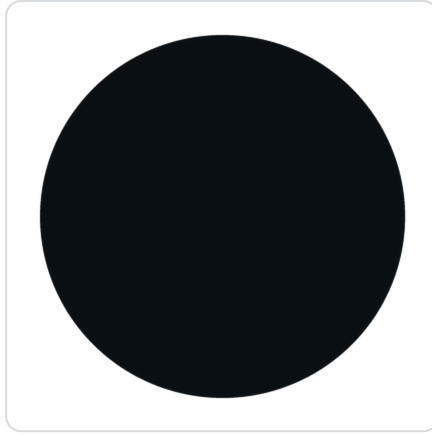
primary logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)



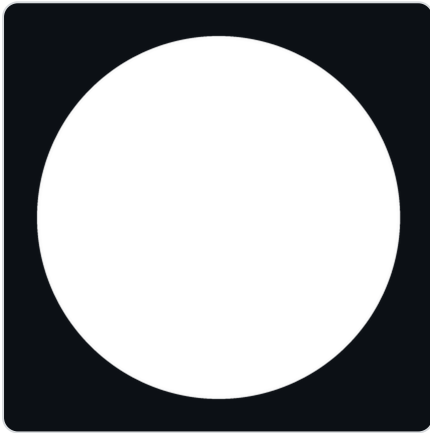
symbol logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in

Version	Use it for	Avoid
Full colour (primary)	Our first choice. White backgrounds only: letters, reports, the website header, forms, email	Any background other than white
Symbol, full colour	Social media profile pictures, favicons, app icons, stickers, small spaces where the full logo would fall below its minimum size	Places where people may not already know who we are: always show our name nearby in text
Single colour, dark (knockout)	Light neutral, Sunset Coral and Tide Blue backgrounds; one-colour printing such as photocopied leaflets, newspaper adverts and fax-quality forms	White backgrounds where full colour is possible
Single colour, light (knockout, reversed)	Harbour Blue and dark neutral backgrounds; dark photo areas; merchandise printed in white	Light backgrounds
Symbol, single colour	Embroidery, engraving, rubber stamps, small one-colour items	Anywhere the full-colour symbol works

Why knockout. Our single-colour logos use the *knockout* style: the sun and the waves are cut out of the circle so the background shows through. The plain single-colour style fills the whole circle with one colour and erases the sun and waves completely, so we never use it. In knockout, the Tide Blue band merges into the circle, leaving two clear waves. That is expected.

The variant files were produced automatically from a PNG. Before you use a single-colour logo for print, signage, embroidery or engraving, ask the Communications team for designer-checked vector artwork.

Clear space

Keep a clear area around the logo, free of text, images, edges and other logos. The rule, shown in the specifications table below, is based on the height of the sun in the symbol, so it scales with the logo and you can measure it on any proof by eye.

Clear space gives the logo room to be noticed and stops it being read as part of nearby text or a partner's logo. Treat the clear space as a minimum: more space is always fine. The `-clearspace` PNG files have it built in, so placing them edge to edge with other content keeps you safe.

Do use the `-clearspace` versions of the logo files in Word, PowerPoint and Canva, so the margin comes with the file.

Don't let the clear space overlap a page edge, a fold, a photo edge or a partner's logo.

Minimum size

Logo specifications

Rule	Specification
Logo type	combination
Clear space	Keep clear space on all sides equal to the height of the sun in the symbol (about a quarter of the logo's height).
Minimum size (screen)	160 px wide
Minimum size (print)	40 mm wide
Symbol minimum size	24 px / 8 mm
Proportions	3.471 : 1 (width : height), wide-horizontal
Alt text	"Harbourside Community Trust logo"

The minimum size is set by "Community Trust", the smallest and lightest part of the logo. Below it, the letters blur on screen and fill in when printed on uncoated paper.

- **Below the full logo's minimum width**, switch to the symbol and write our name in text nearby (for example, in the post caption, the page title or the line under the icon).
- **Below the symbol's minimum size**, don't use the logo at all. Favicons are the only exception and have their own prepared files (chapter 14).
- **Signage and large print**: there is no maximum size, but you need vector artwork to print large (see "Files and naming").

Placement

Place the logo consistently so people know where to look for it.

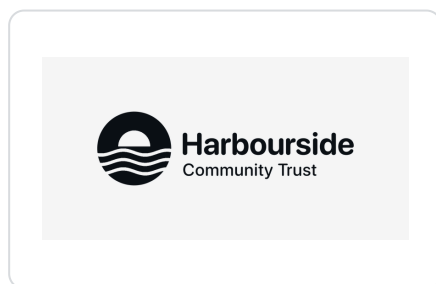
Format	Position	Size guide
Website and email header	Top left, aligned to the grid's left margin, linked to the home page	Never below the minimum width; on mobile, keep the full logo if it fits, otherwise use the symbol with our name as text
Letters, reports, A4 and A5 print	Top left, inside the page margin	About a quarter to a third of the page width on covers; smaller on inside pages
Posters and flyers	Top left or bottom left, inside the safe margin	Large enough to read from the expected viewing distance
Social posts and video	Bottom left or bottom right, inside the platform's safe zone (chapter 15)	Same corner and size across a whole campaign
Slides	Title and end slides only; small in a footer corner on content slides if needed	Never on every slide at full size
Avatars and app icons	Symbol, centred	Leave the circular crop margin built into the asset files

Align the logo to the layout grid (chapter 06): the left edge of the artwork, not of its clear space, sits on the margin. Use one placement for every item in a campaign.

Backgrounds



On white (#ffffff): use **full-colour** (2.95:1). Full colour allowed as an approved exception (2.95:1).



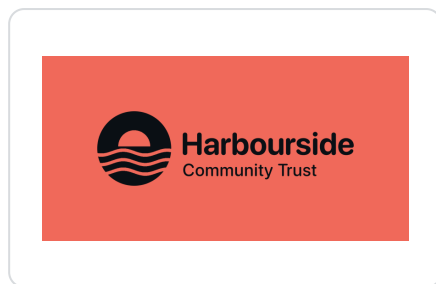
On light-neutral (#f6f7f8): use **mono-dark** (17.79:1). Full colour not allowed (2.75:1).



On primary (#1d4e89): use **mono-light** (8.39:1). Full colour not allowed (1.0:1).



On dark (#0c1015): use **mono-light** (19.08:1). Full colour not allowed (2.27:1).



On secondary (#f36c5c): use **mono-dark** (6.46:1). Full colour not allowed (1.0:1).



On accent (#9ec8e7): use **mono-dark** (10.78:1). Full colour not allowed (1.67:1).

Which logo version to use on each background (minimum 3:1)

Background	Use this version	Contrast	Full colour allowed?
☐ white	full-colour	2.95:1	Yes, approved exception (2.95:1)
☐ light-neutral	mono-dark	17.79:1	No (2.75:1)
☒ primary	mono-light	8.39:1	No (1.0:1)
☒ dark	mono-light	19.08:1	No (2.27:1)
☒ secondary	mono-dark	6.46:1	No (1.0:1)
☒ accent	mono-dark	10.78:1	No (1.67:1)

How to choose

- **White:** use the full-colour logo. This is our master presentation.
- **Light neutral, Sunset Coral and Tide Blue:** use the single-colour dark knockout logo. Full colour is not allowed on these backgrounds: on light neutral, "Community Trust" in Sunset Coral drops further below 3:1, and on Sunset Coral or Tide Blue, parts of the logo disappear into the background.
- **Harbour Blue and dark neutral:** use the single-colour light (reversed) knockout logo. The Harbour Blue circle and wordmark would vanish on these backgrounds.
- **Tints and other colours:** use whichever single-colour version reaches at least 3:1 against the background. If in doubt, ask the Communications team.

The white-background exception. In full colour, "Community Trust" in Sunset Coral is 2.95:1 against white, just under the 3:1 we require for graphics. WCAG 2.2 exempts logotypes from contrast requirements, so the full-colour logo is approved on white as our master presentation. This exception is pending sign-off by the Communications team, and it has two conditions. First, the logo must never be the only place our name appears: the name must also be in live text, alt text or the page title. Second, the exception covers white only, not off-whites, tints or paper colours.

Photographs and patterns

- Place the logo only on a calm, even part of a photo, such as sky, sea or a plain wall, where the area directly behind the logo keeps at least 3:1 with it.
- If no calm area exists, put the logo on a solid white panel (full colour) or a Harbour Blue panel (reversed), with the clear space inside the panel. Use radius tokens from chapter 06 for the panel corners.
- Never place the logo over faces, text, busy patterns, or the join between light and dark areas.

Misuse

The logo only works if it looks the same everywhere. Don't change it in any of these ways.

Don't stretch, squash or skew the logo. Always scale it in proportion (hold Shift while resizing).

Don't rotate, tilt or flip the logo, or set it on a curve.

Don't recolour any part of it, swap Harbour Blue and Sunset Coral, or use tints, gradients or colours from outside our palette.

Don't add shadows, glows, bevels, outlines, textures or 3D effects.

Don't move, resize or separate the symbol and wordmark, or rearrange them into a new stacked or centred lock-up.

Don't use the plain single-colour version that fills the whole circle; it erases the sun and waves. Use the knockout version.

Don't put the full-colour logo on any background other than white, or any version on a busy photo or a background with less than 3:1 contrast.

Don't put the logo inside a shape, badge, frame or speech bubble that is not shown in this guide.

Don't retype "Harbourside Community Trust" in another font next to the symbol, or redraw the wordmark.

Don't crop the logo, let a frame or page edge cut through it, or use it below its minimum size.

Don't use old, screenshotted, blurry or low-resolution copies. Download the current files from the asset library.

Files and naming

Format	Use for	Status
SVG	Websites, apps, digital design	<i>To be supplied by a designer</i>
PDF or EPS (vector)	Professional print, signage, vehicles, embroidery, engraving	<i>To be supplied by a designer</i>
PNG (transparent background)	Word, PowerPoint, Google Docs, Canva, email, social media	Available now

We only have the logo as a PNG at present. PNG is fine for screens and office documents, but it cannot be enlarged for posters, banners or signs without blurring. Until vector artwork is available, send print suppliers to the Communications team rather than sending the PNG.

Name logo files like this:

```
harbourside-community-trust-logo-{version}-{colour}.{ext}
```

For example: `harbourside-community-trust-logo-primary-full-colour.png`, `harbourside-community-trust-logo-symbol-mono-light-knockout.svg`. Keep names lower case, with hyphens and no spaces.

Download approved files from the asset library listed in the downloads section of chapter 20. Ask the Communications team at comms@harbourside.example for formats not listed there.

Logo accessibility

- **Alt text:** use the alt text in the specifications table above, "Harbourside Community Trust logo". When the logo links to our home page, use "Harbourside Community Trust home" so screen reader users know where the link goes.
- **Don't repeat the name.** If our name is written as text right next to the logo, give the logo empty alt text (`alt=""`) so screen readers don't read the name twice.
- **Contrast:** apart from the approved white-background exception, keep at least 3:1 between the logo and whatever is directly behind it.
- **Never instead of words:** don't use the logo in place of our name in a sentence, and never make it the only way to identify us. Our name must also appear in text, in the page title or document title, and in alt text.
- **Recognition:** many of our audiences are older residents or people who speak English as a second language. Show our full name in text near the symbol-only logo, so it is recognisable to people who

don't yet know the symbol.

Do place the full-colour logo on white with its clear space and our name repeated in the page text.

Don't put the full-colour logo on light neutral, Tide Blue or a photograph; use the single-colour knockout version instead.

Colour

Our colours come straight from the logo: the deep blue of the harbour, the warm coral of a rising sun and the soft blue of the tide. Used consistently, they make us recognisable at a glance. Used carefully, they keep every word readable for older residents, people with low vision and people with colour-vision deficiencies.

Our colours

Primary	Secondary	Accent
Harbour Blue HEX #1d4e89 RGB (29 78 137) HSL (213 65% 33%) oklch(42.3% 0.111 255.1) CMYK C79 M43 Y0 K46 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 8.39:1 (AAA) White text on it: 8.39:1 (AAA) As text on white: use as is	Sunset Coral HEX #f36c5c RGB (243 108 92) HSL (6 86% 66%) oklch(69.3% 0.169 29.0) CMYK C0 M56 Y62 K5 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 2.95:1 (Fail) Dark text on it: 6.46:1 (AA) As text on white: use secondary-600 #bd3126	Tide Blue HEX #9ec8e7 RGB (158 200 231) HSL (205 60% 76%) oklch(81.3% 0.063 240.5) CMYK C32 M13 Y0 K9 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 1.77:1 (Fail) Dark text on it: 10.78:1 (AAA) As text on white: use accent- 600 #397298

Colour	Role	Personality	Use it for
Harbour Blue	Primary	Calm, dependable, local	Headlines, the website header and footer, primary buttons, large brand panels, the reversed logo background
Sunset Coral	Secondary	Warm, hopeful, kind	Highlights, illustrations, shapes and large panels that carry dark text; calls to action using its darker step
Tide Blue	Accent	Gentle, fresh, coastal	Backgrounds of cards and quote panels, wave dividers, illustration fills
Neutrals	Text and surfaces	Quiet, clear	Body text, backgrounds, borders, dividers

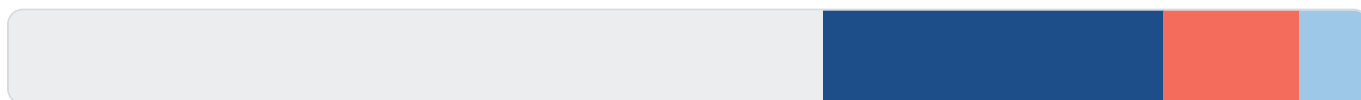
Harbour Blue is dark enough to use for text at its exact value. Sunset Coral and Tide Blue are not: on white they are for shapes and large areas only. When you need either as text, use its 600 step (secondary-600 , accent-600). Never lighten or darken the exact logo colours to make them pass; use a scale step instead and keep the exact colour for the logo and large fills.

Colour values

The swatches above give HEX and RGB for screens, HSL and OKLCH for developers, and CMYK for print.

- **CMYK** values are a mathematical starting point, not a print specification. Ask your printer for a proof and compare it with a screen calibrated by the Communications team or a previous printed sample.
- **Pantone** spot colours have not been chosen. They must be matched from a physical Pantone swatch book under daylight-balanced light, separately for coated (C) and uncoated (U) paper, because the same ink looks different on each. Until then, print in CMYK.

Proportions



Approximate share of colour across a typical layout

☐ Neutrals and white 60% ☒ Harbour Blue 25% ☒ Sunset Coral 10% ☒ Tide Blue 5%

Most of what we make should feel light, open and calm, with colour used to guide the eye. For example, on an A5 flyer:

- **Neutral (60%):** a white or light neutral page with near-black body text.
- **Harbour Blue (25%):** the headline and a footer band carrying the reversed logo and contact details.
- **Sunset Coral (10%):** one highlight, such as a rounded shape behind the key date, set with dark text.

- **Tide Blue (5%):** a wave divider or a light panel behind a quote.

One warm Sunset Coral moment per page is enough. More than that, and nothing stands out.

Tonal scales and tokens

Harbour Blue tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 primary-50	#f2f7ff	1.08:1 (Fail)	19.52:1 (AAA)	Dark
 primary-100	#e1eeff	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.88:1 (AAA)	Dark
 primary-200	#c3ddff	1.39:1 (Fail)	15.11:1 (AAA)	Dark
 primary-300	#99c4fc	1.80:1 (Fail)	11.66:1 (AAA)	Dark
 primary-400	#6ea4ea	2.57:1 (Fail)	8.16:1 (AAA)	Dark
 primary-500	#4c88d3	3.64:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.77:1 (AA)	Dark
 primary-600	#356db2	5.27:1 (AA)	3.98:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 primary-700	#1d4e89	8.39:1 (AAA)	2.50:1 (Fail)	White
 primary-800	#184070	10.47:1 (AAA)	2.01:1 (Fail)	White
 primary-900	#0d2b50	14.20:1 (AAA)	1.48:1 (Fail)	White
 primary-950	#041832	17.77:1 (AAA)	1.18:1 (Fail)	White

Sunset Coral tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 secondary-50	#fff4f2	1.08:1 (Fail)	19.47:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-100	#ffe6e2	1.19:1 (Fail)	17.67:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-200	#ffcdc5	1.42:1 (Fail)	14.79:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-300	#ffa699	1.88:1 (Fail)	11.17:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-400	#f36c5c	2.95:1 (Fail)	7.11:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-500	#e14b3d	3.98:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.28:1 (AA)	Dark
 secondary-600	#bd3126	5.78:1 (AA)	3.63:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 secondary-700	#9b2018	8.04:1 (AAA)	2.61:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-800	#77130d	11.15:1 (AAA)	1.88:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-900	#550805	14.76:1 (AAA)	1.42:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-950	#360101	18.08:1 (AAA)	1.16:1 (Fail)	White

Tide Blue tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 accent-50	#f1f8fd	1.07:1 (Fail)	19.59:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-100	#e0effb	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.91:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-200	#c4dff3	1.38:1 (Fail)	15.20:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-300	#9ec8e7	1.77:1 (Fail)	11.87:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-400	#72a8cf	2.56:1 (Fail)	8.22:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-500	#518db7	3.59:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.84:1 (AA)	Dark
 accent-600	#397298	5.21:1 (AA)	4.03:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 accent-700	#295a7b	7.39:1 (AAA)	2.84:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-800	#1b445e	10.32:1 (AAA)	2.04:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-900	#0f2e42	14.10:1 (AAA)	1.49:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-950	#051a29	17.70:1 (AAA)	1.19:1 (Fail)	White

Neutral tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 neutral-50	#f6f7f8	1.07:1 (Fail)	19.58:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-100	#ebedef	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.89:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-200	#d8dbde	1.39:1 (Fail)	15.11:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-300	#bdc1c6	1.81:1 (Fail)	11.61:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-400	#9da2a8	2.57:1 (Fail)	8.17:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-500	#81878d	3.63:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.78:1 (AA)	Dark
 neutral-600	#676c72	5.30:1 (AA)	3.96:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 neutral-700	#52565b	7.39:1 (AAA)	2.84:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-800	#3d4044	10.42:1 (AAA)	2.02:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-900	#292c2f	14.04:1 (AAA)	1.50:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-950	#0c1015	19.08:1 (AAA)	1.10:1 (Fail)	White

Each colour has a scale from 50 (lightest) to 950 (darkest). Refer to colours by token name, such as `primary-600`, so designers and developers use the same values.

Steps	Use for
50–100	Page and card backgrounds, highlighted table rows
200–300	Decorative borders, dividers, illustration fills
400–500	Icons, chart marks, form borders and other UI (check 3:1)
600	Text and links on white; buttons with white text
700–950	Headings, dark panels, text on light tints

Key tokens: `text-default` is `neutral-900`, `text-muted` is `neutral-600`, `text-link` is `primary-600`, `border-strong` is `neutral-500`, `border-subtle` is `neutral-200` (decorative only), and `surface-brand` is `primary-600`.

Accessible pairings

Approved colour pairings and WCAG 2.2 contrast

Sample	Use	Foreground	Background	Ratio	Approved for	Result
	Body text on light background	neutral-900 #292c2f	white #ffffff	14.04:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Secondary text / captions on light background	neutral-600 #676c72	white #ffffff	5.30:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Body text on dark background	neutral-50 #f6f7f8	neutral-950 #0c1015	17.79:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Harbour Blue text and links on light background	primary-600 #356db2	white #ffffff	5.27:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Harbour Blue buttons and banners	white #ffffff	primary-600 #356db2	5.27:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Harbour Blue text and links on dark background	primary-500 #4c88d3	neutral-950 #0c1015	5.24:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Exact Harbour Blue on white (any text)	primary #1d4e89	white #ffffff	8.39:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Harbour Blue background	white #ffffff	primary #1d4e89	8.39:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Sunset Coral text and links on light background	secondary-600 #bd3126	white #ffffff	5.78:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Sunset Coral buttons and banners	white #ffffff	secondary-600 #bd3126	5.78:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓

Sample	Use	Foreground	Background	Ratio	Approved for	Result
	Sunset Coral text and links on dark background	secondary-500 #e14b3d	neutral-950 #0c1015	4.79:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Exact Sunset Coral on white (decorative only - not for text or meaningful graphics)	secondary #f36c5c	white #ffffff	2.95:1	Decorative only	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Sunset Coral background	neutral-950 #0c1015	secondary #f36c5c	6.46:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Tide Blue text and links on light background	accent-600 #397298	white #ffffff	5.21:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Tide Blue buttons and banners	white #ffffff	accent-600 #397298	5.21:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Tide Blue text and links on dark background	accent-500 #518db7	neutral-950 #0c1015	5.31:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Exact Tide Blue on white (decorative only - not for text or meaningful graphics)	accent #9ec8e7	white #ffffff	1.77:1	Decorative only	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Tide Blue background	neutral-950 #0c1015	accent #9ec8e7	10.78:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Success message text on tinted background	success-600 #00823a	success-50 #eefbf0	4.63:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓

Sample	Use	Foreground	Background	Ratio	Approved for	Result
	Warning message text on tinted background	warning-600 #916100	warning-50 #fff5e9	4.98:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Error message text on tinted background	error-600 #b33f38	error-50 #fff4f2	5.29:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Info message text on tinted background	info-600 #006ebe	info-50 #f1f8ff	4.93:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Harbour Blue text on Tide Blue panels	#1d4e89 #1d4e89	#9ec8e7 #9ec8e7	4.74:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Tide Blue text on Harbour Blue	#9ec8e7 #9ec8e7	#1d4e89 #1d4e89	4.74:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Harbour Blue text on primary-100 tint	#1d4e89 #1d4e89	#e1eeff #e1eeff	7.14:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Harbour Blue headings on light neutral	#1d4e89 #1d4e89	#f6f7f8 #f6f7f8	7.82:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Sunset Coral text on dark neutral	#f36c5c #f36c5c	#0c1015 #0c1015	6.46:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓

Every pairing in the table has been checked against WCAG 2.2 AA:

- **Any text (4.5:1):** safe for body text, links, buttons and captions.
- **Large text and UI only (3:1):** text 24px and above (or 18.66px bold), icons, borders and chart marks.
- **Decorative only:** shapes and fills that carry no information. Never use these for text, icons or chart marks.

Buttons: use `surface-brand` with `text-on-brand` (white text on Harbour Blue) as the primary button. For a warm call to action such as "Donate", use `secondary-600` with white text. Exact Sunset Coral with `neutral-950` text works for large panels and stickers, but don't use it for buttons on white, because its edge is less than 3:1 against the page.

Focus rings: inside Harbour Blue sections, use the white focus ring; inside Sunset Coral and Tide Blue sections, use the `neutral-950` ring. These are the `focus.onBrand` colours, listed in chapter 13.

Never combine

These combinations fail contrast, but people will be tempted to use them:

- White text on exact Sunset Coral or exact Tide Blue.
- Exact Sunset Coral or exact Tide Blue text, icons or thin lines on white or light neutral.
- Sunset Coral text on Harbour Blue (it is below 3:1, although the sun in the logo is fine because it is artwork).
- Harbour Blue text on the dark neutral background in dark mode.
- Mid-grey neutral-400 or lighter for any text on white.

Note Harbour Blue text on Tide Blue panels, Tide Blue text on Harbour Blue and Harbour Blue on light tints all pass 4.5:1. We have proposed adding them to the approved table so they can be used for quote panels and highlights.

State colours

State colours (always pair with an icon and text)

State	Text / icon	Background	Border	Solid (white text)
Success	 #00823a	 #eefbf0	 #20a04e	 #00823a
Warning	 #916100	 #fff5e9	 #b37900	 #916100
Error	 #b33f38	 #fff4f2	 #d5584f	 #b33f38
Info	 #006ebe	 #f1f8ff	 #2389e2	 #006ebe

Success, warning, error and information messages use their own colours, never brand colours.

- **Always use an icon and words**, not colour alone: "Error: enter your postcode" with an error icon, not just a red border.
- **Sunset Coral is close to the error colour.** Keep Sunset Coral out of forms and error messages, and keep the error colour out of marketing. Sunset Coral tints (secondary-50 , secondary-100) look almost the same as the error background, so don't use them as panel backgrounds on forms or account pages.
- **Harbour Blue and Tide Blue are close to the information colour.** Information messages must use the info tokens with an information icon and a heading such as "Good to know", never a plain blue box.

Colour-vision deficiency

How key colours appear with colour-vision deficiencies (simulated)

Colour	Typical vision	Protanopia	Deuteranopia	Tritanopia	Achromatopsia
Harbour Blue	 #1d4e89	 #31538b	 #1e4988	 #005c64	 #4d4d4d
Sunset Coral	 #f36c5c	 #8e845a	 #b0a159	 #ff5269	 #969696
Tide Blue	 #9ec8e7	 #bbc7e9	 #b1bfe6	 #87d0d2	 #c3c3c3
Success	 #00823a	 #837634	 #766d40	 #007f72	 #707070
Warning	 #916100	 #726400	 #7e6f06	 #9f5452	 #6b6b6b
Error	 #b33f38	 #5e5736	 #7b7035	 #c4233e	 #666666
Info	 #006ebe	 #4474c1	 #2365bc	 #00818c	 #6c6c6c

Pairs that may be confused — never use these together as the only way to tell things apart:

- Sunset Coral and Success (protanopia)
- Success and Warning (protanopia)
- Success and Warning (deuteranopia)
- Success and Error (deuteranopia)
- Success and Info (tritanopia)
- Warning and Error (protanopia)
- Warning and Error (deuteranopia)

About 1 in 12 men and 1 in 200 women have some form of colour-vision deficiency. The table simulates how our colours appear to them. The pairs listed may look the same, so wherever they appear together:

- **Success, warning and error** can be confused with each other. Always add a distinct icon (tick, triangle, cross) and a text label.
- **Success and information** can be confused (tritanopia). Use different icons and headings.
- **Sunset Coral and the success colour** can be confused (protanopia). Never use Sunset Coral to mean "bad" or "done".

- In charts, maps and timetables, separate these colours with labels, patterns or a clear difference in lightness (chapter 09).

Dark mode

Dark mode swaps surfaces and text, and uses lighter steps of each brand colour:

Purpose	Light mode	Dark mode
Page background	white	neutral-950
Body text	neutral-900	neutral-50
Links and Harbour Blue text	primary-600	primary-500
Sunset Coral text	secondary-600	secondary-500
Tide Blue text	accent-600	accent-500
Logo	Full colour	Single colour, light (reversed) knockout

Use the dark neutral (neutral-950) rather than pure black for large surfaces: it is softer on the eyes and keeps the blue character of the brand.

Colour in data visualisation

Charts use brand colours first, in a fixed order, with every mark at least 3:1 against its background and a white gap between neighbouring bars or segments. Label data directly and add patterns for print. Chapter 09 sets out the series order and rules.

Print and other media

- **Litho and digital print:** use CMYK until Pantone references are matched (see "Colour values"). Always ask for a hard-copy proof for anything printed in quantity.
- **Uncoated paper** makes colours look duller and darker. Check proofs on the actual stock.
- **Embroidery:** match thread colours to a physical sample of the printed logo, not to a screen. Use the single-colour symbol for small embroidery.
- **Signage paint and vinyl:** match to a RAL, NCS or vinyl manufacturer's swatch, chosen against a printed proof. Record the references in the asset library once agreed.
- **Screens** vary. Judge colour on a calibrated monitor, and never approve print colour from a phone screen.

Colour: do and don't

Do use Harbour Blue for headlines and large brand areas, with plenty of white space around them.

Do use `secondary-600` or `accent-600` whenever Sunset Coral or Tide Blue needs to be text or a link.

Do pair every status colour with an icon and words.

Don't put white text on exact Sunset Coral or exact Tide Blue.

Don't use Sunset Coral in error messages, or the error colour in marketing.

Don't invent new colours, tints with transparency over photos, or gradients behind text.

Accessibility Never rely on colour alone to carry meaning. Pair it with text, icons, patterns or position.

Typography

Many of the people we write for are older, have low vision, or read English as a second language. Our type is chosen to be friendly like our logo and, above all, easy to read: clear letter shapes, generous sizes and plain layouts.

Our typefaces

Typefaces

Role	Typeface	Weights	Fallback stack	Source	Licence
Display	Nunito	400, 600, 700, 800	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1
Body	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next	400, 600, 700	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1
Mono	JetBrains Mono	400, 600	ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Consolas, monospace	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1

Nunito: display

Nunito is a rounded sans-serif. Its soft, rounded stroke ends echo the heavy, rounded letters of "Harbourside" in our logo, so headlines feel part of the same family. (We have not identified the typeface used in the logo itself; Nunito is chosen because it is similar in feel, not because it is the same font.)

- Use **ExtraBold (800)** or **Bold (700)** for the `display`, `h1` and `h2` styles, and **SemiBold (600)** for `h3`.
- Use **Regular (400)** only for large pull quotes.
- Don't use the Light and ExtraLight weights: thin strokes are hard to read for people with low vision.

Atkinson Hyperlegible Next: body

Atkinson Hyperlegible Next was designed with the Braille Institute for readers with low vision. Letters that are often confused, such as capital I, lower-case l and the number 1, or capital O and zero, are drawn to look clearly different. That makes it a strong fit for older residents and anyone reading in a second language.

- Use **Regular (400)** for body text, **SemiBold (600)** for labels and `h4`, and **Bold (700)** for emphasis.
- Use its true italic for titles and terms only.

JetBrains Mono: code and reference numbers

Use JetBrains Mono, with the `code` style, only for reference numbers, case IDs, code and data tables on our website. Don't use it for headings or body text.

Getting the fonts and licences

All three typefaces are free under the **SIL Open Font License 1.1**. You may use them in print, on the web, in apps, on social media, in video and in broadcast, and embed them in PDFs. You must not sell the font files themselves.

- **Website:** self-host the font files (download from Google Fonts) rather than linking to Google's servers, which avoids sending visitor data to a third party. Load only the weights listed above.
- **Desktop (design and office):** download from the Google Fonts specimen pages linked in the table and install them. Staff laptops need IT to install fonts; ask the Communications team.
- **Canva and Google Docs:** Nunito is available in both. Search for Atkinson Hyperlegible in the font menu; if only the original Atkinson Hyperlegible is offered, you may use it.
- **Video and social graphics:** fonts are covered; embed or outline them in exported files.

Fallbacks and substitutes

When our fonts are not available, use these substitutes so documents still look tidy and stay readable.

Where	Headings	Body text
Websites (automatic fallback)	The fallback stack in the table above	The fallback stack in the table above
Word, PowerPoint, Outlook (fonts not installed)	Arial, Bold	Verdana, Regular
Google Docs and Slides	Nunito, Bold	Atkinson Hyperlegible, or Verdana
Email newsletters and signatures	Arial, Bold	Verdana, Arial, sans-serif

We choose Verdana for body text because, like Atkinson Hyperlegible Next, it is wide and open, with letters that are easy to tell apart at small sizes. Verdana runs wider than our body font, so expect longer documents; reduce the size by no more than one point (and never below the minimums in "Readable text").

Don't send Word or PowerPoint files that rely on our fonts to partners who may not have them. Export a PDF with fonts embedded, or use the substitute fonts.

Type scale and hierarchy

Clear, confident, kind

display — 60px / 3.75rem, line height 1.1, weight 700, tracking -0.02em. Campaign headlines, hero banners (one per page)

Clear, confident, kind

h1 — 48px / 3rem, line height 1.15, weight 700, tracking -0.015em. Page titles

Clear, confident, kind

h2 — 36px / 2.25rem, line height 1.2, weight 700, tracking -0.01em. Section titles

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

h3 — 28px / 1.75rem, line height 1.25, weight 600, tracking 0. Sub-sections

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

h4 — 22px / 1.375rem, line height 1.3, weight 600, tracking 0. Card and component titles

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

body-lg — 20px / 1.25rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Introductions and lead paragraphs

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

body — 16px / 1rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Default body text (never smaller on screen)

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

small — 14px / 0.875rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0.01em. Captions, metadata, legal (not for long passages)

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

label — 14px / 0.875rem, line height 1.4, weight 600, tracking 0.02em. Buttons, form labels, tags

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

code — 15px / 0.9375rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Code, data, reference numbers

Type scale

Token	Size	Line height	Weight	Tracking	Family	Use
display	60px (3.75rem)	1.1	700	-0.02em	display	Campaign headlines, hero banners (one per page)
h1	48px (3rem)	1.15	700	-0.015em	display	Page titles
h2	36px (2.25rem)	1.2	700	-0.01em	display	Section titles
h3	28px (1.75rem)	1.25	600	0	display	Sub-sections
h4	22px (1.375rem)	1.3	600	0	body	Card and component titles
body-lg	20px (1.25rem)	1.5	400	0	body	Introductions and lead paragraphs
body	16px (1rem)	1.5	400	0	body	Default body text (never smaller on screen)
small	14px (0.875rem)	1.5	400	0.01em	body	Captions, metadata, legal (not for long passages)
label	14px (0.875rem)	1.4	600	0.02em	body	Buttons, form labels, tags
code	15px (0.9375rem)	1.5	400	0	mono	Code, data, reference numbers

The scale goes up in steps of about 1.25, from 16px body text. Each style has one job:

- **display** : one campaign headline or hero banner per page.
- **h1** : the page or document title. Exactly one per page.
- **h2** , **h3** , **h4** : sections, sub-sections and card titles. Don't skip levels: an **h3** always sits inside an **h2** .
- **body-lg** : the first paragraph of an article, or short introductions.

- **body** : all running text.
- **small** : captions, dates and legal notes. Never for whole paragraphs.
- **label** : buttons, form labels and tags.

Choose heading levels for structure, not for size. Headings should describe what follows ("How to apply for a food parcel", not "Next steps"), because many people jump between headings with a screen reader or by scanning.

On screens narrower than 768px, *proposed*: reduce **display** to 40px, **h1** to 36px, **h2** to 28px and **h3** to 24px, keeping weights and line heights. Body sizes stay the same.

Readable text

- **Line length**: keep lines to the measure in the type settings, 45–75 characters (about 66 is ideal). On wide screens, limit the text column, not the font size.
- **Line height**: at least 1.5 for body text; 1.1–1.3 for headings, as set in the scale.
- **Paragraph spacing**: leave at least one line of space between paragraphs (**space-4** or more on screen).
- **Alignment**: left-aligned, with a ragged right edge. Never justify text: it creates uneven gaps that make reading harder, especially for people with dyslexia.
- **Capitals**: use sentence case for headings and buttons. Avoid all caps except for a short label of no more than three words.
- **Italics**: no more than one sentence at a time.

Minimum sizes

Medium	Body text	Smallest text
Websites and email	16px (body)	14px (small)
Printed letters, leaflets and posters for families and residents	14pt	10pt for footnotes and legal lines
Reports for partners and internal documents	12pt	9pt for footnotes
Large-print versions (on request)	16pt or larger	14pt
Posters and signs	See chapter 18	—
Text on social images	At least 4% of the image height	—
Slides	24pt	18pt

Because many readers are older, never set public materials below 14pt body text, and never use 11pt for body text anywhere.

Emphasis

- Use **bold** for emphasis, sparingly.
- Use *italics* only for titles of publications and to introduce a term.
- Underline is reserved for links. Never underline text for emphasis.
- Don't use colour alone for emphasis: a word in Harbour Blue is not emphasised for someone who can't see the difference.

Numbers

- In tables, financial summaries and charts, use tabular (equal-width) figures so columns line up. Check that the font supports them in your software (in CSS, `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`); if not, right-align the numbers.
- Use lining figures (the default) in interface text.
- Follow the date, time, money and phone number formats in chapter 12.

Languages

We work with families who speak many languages. Before publishing in any language other than English, check that every character displays correctly.

- **Latin-script languages** such as Polish, Romanian, Lithuanian, Portuguese, Turkish and Vietnamese: both Nunito and Atkinson Hyperlegible Next are published with extended Latin character sets, but check the specific letters before you print, for example Polish ą ę ł ś ź ż, Romanian ș ț (with a comma below, not a cedilla) and Turkish ğ ı ş. Look at the "Glyphs" or "Language support" section on the Google Fonts specimen page.
- **Cyrillic** (for example Ukrainian or Russian): check coverage for each font on its specimen page. If a font lacks Cyrillic, use Noto Sans for that language.
- **Scripts our fonts don't cover**, such as Arabic, Urdu, Persian, Kurdish (Sorani), Bengali, Punjabi (Gurmukhi), Tamil, Amharic or Tigrinya, and Chinese: use the matching **Noto Sans** family (for example Noto Sans Arabic, Noto Sans Bengali, Noto Sans SC), which is also free under the SIL Open Font License. Keep our English headings in Nunito if the page is bilingual.
- **Right-to-left languages** (Arabic, Urdu, Persian): align text to the right, mirror the layout (navigation, icons that point forwards), never add letter-spacing (it breaks joined letters), and don't use italics. Ask a native speaker to check the layout before printing.
- **Translations are often longer than English** (often 20–30% longer). Leave room in layouts rather than shrinking the text.
- **Hyphenation**: turn automatic hyphenation off in English. For other languages, ask the translator.

Typography accessibility

- Text must stay readable when zoomed to 200%, and websites must allow people to change line, letter and word spacing without content being cut off.
- Never use images of text. Posters and graphics shared online must repeat their words in the post text or alt text.
- For readers with dyslexia, spacing, left alignment, short lines and plain words matter more than any "special" font. Our body font and these rules already serve them well.
- Keep contrast to the approved pairings in chapter 04.

Typography: do and don't

Do use Nunito for headlines and Atkinson Hyperlegible Next for everything people need to read.

Do set body text at 16px on screen, 14pt in print for families and residents, and 12pt for partner reports.

Don't use more than two typefaces in one design (JetBrains Mono for reference numbers is the only exception).

Don't set long passages in Nunito below 20px, track out (letter-space) body text, or squash text to fit.

Don't use your software's fake bold or fake italic buttons with a font that lacks those styles; install the real weights.

Layout, grid and spacing

Good layout makes our information easy to find and calm to read, which matters when someone is looking for help with housing, food or work. Our layouts are open and card-based, with rounded corners that echo the circle and waves of our logo.

Spacing

	space-0	0px
	space-1	4px
■	space-2	8px
■	space-3	12px
■	space-4	16px
■	space-5	24px
■	space-6	32px
■	space-7	40px
■	space-8	48px
■	space-9	64px
■	space-10	80px
■	space-11	96px
■	space-12	128px

Spacing scale (base unit 4px)

Token	Pixels	rem
space-0	0px	0rem
space-1	4px	0.25rem
space-2	8px	0.5rem
space-3	12px	0.75rem
space-4	16px	1rem
space-5	24px	1.5rem
space-6	32px	2rem
space-7	40px	2.5rem
space-8	48px	3rem
space-9	64px	4rem
space-10	80px	5rem
space-11	96px	6rem
space-12	128px	8rem

All spacing is a multiple of our 4px base unit. Use the `space-*` tokens rather than typing your own values, so every page shares the same rhythm.

Use	Token
Between an icon and its label; inside tags	<code>space-2</code>
Inside buttons and form fields; between a label and its field	<code>space-3</code> to <code>space-4</code>
Between paragraphs; inside small cards	<code>space-4</code> to <code>space-5</code>
Inside large cards and panels; between form groups	<code>space-6</code>
Between sections	<code>space-9</code> to <code>space-10</code>
Above and below page-level bands (hero, footer)	<code>space-11</code> to <code>space-12</code>

Related items sit closer together than unrelated ones. If two things look equally spaced, people assume they are equally related.

Grid

Layout grid (maximum content width 1280px)

Breakpoint	Viewport	Columns	Gutter	Margin
Mobile	0px+	4	16px	16px
Tablet	768px+	8	24px	32px
Desktop	1024px+	12	24px	48px
Wide	1440px+	12	32px	80px

- Text columns never span the full grid. Keep paragraphs to the line length in chapter 05; on desktop, that is roughly 6 to 8 of the 12 columns.
- On mobile, stack cards in a single column, in the same order as the desktop reading order.
- Align the logo, headings and body text to the same left margin.

Common formats

Format	Margins	Grid	Notes
Web page	As the grid table	4, 8 or 12 columns	Content no wider than the maximum content width
A4 and A5 print	15mm (A5) to 20mm (A4), plus 3mm bleed	12 columns (A4) or 6 columns (A5), 5mm gutters	Logo top left inside the margin
Slides (16:9)	At least 80px at 1920×1080	12 columns	One idea per slide; see chapter 17
Social square and portrait	At least 80px at 1080px wide	4 columns	Keep text inside the platform safe zone (chapter 15)

Composition

- **One focal point per layout:** a headline, a photo or a key number, not all three competing.

- **White space is part of the design:** it gives the page the calm, uncluttered feel of our brand. Don't fill every gap.
- **Clear hierarchy:** headline, then supporting text, then the action. Put the most important information, such as a phone number or opening times, where people look first.
- **Consistent alignment:** left-align text blocks to the grid. Centre only short headlines on posters, social cards and end slides.

Corner radius

Corner radius

Token	Value	Typical use
<code>radius-none</code>	0px	Tables, full-bleed images
<code>radius-sm</code>	6px	Inputs, tags
<code>radius-md</code>	12px	Buttons, cards
<code>radius-lg</code>	16px	Panels, modals
<code>radius-xl</code>	28px	Feature cards, media
<code>radius-pill</code>	fully rounded	Pills, avatars, toggles

Our corners are noticeably rounded, to match the circular symbol and the rounded letters of the wordmark.

- Use `radius-md` for buttons and cards, `radius-sm` for inputs and tags, `radius-lg` for panels and dialogs, and `radius-xl` for feature cards and photos in marketing layouts.
- Use `radius-pill` for avatars, status pills and toggles.
- Use one radius per component type throughout a design; don't mix rounded and square cards.
- Keep tables, full-bleed photos and page edges square (`radius-none`).
- When a rounded item sits inside another, the inner radius is smaller than the outer one, so the gap between them looks even.

Elevation

Elevation (shadows)

Token	Value	Use
shadow-0	none	Flat surfaces
shadow-1	0 1px 2px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.08), 0 1px 1px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.04)	Cards, raised buttons
shadow-2	0 4px 8px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.08), 0 2px 4px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.04)	Dropdowns, popovers
shadow-3	0 12px 24px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.10), 0 4px 8px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.05)	Modals, dialogs

We are a flat, friendly brand: most surfaces use `shadow-0` and are separated by colour, space or a `border-subtle` line. Use `shadow-1` for cards that can be clicked, `shadow-2` for menus and pop-ups, and `shadow-3` only for dialogs. Shadows are decorative; a card's edge must still be clear without them (use a border or a background tint).

Supporting graphic: the wave line

Proposed — confirm with the Communications team: the three wave lines from the symbol may be used on their own as a section divider or the edge of a panel, in Tide Blue, Harbour Blue or white. A designer should draw this from vector artwork. Never use the sun on its own as a graphic, or the wave line where it could be mistaken for the logo; and never place text on top of it.

Layout accessibility

- **Reflow:** web pages must work at 320px wide without horizontal scrolling, except for data tables, maps and diagrams.
- **Zoom:** text must remain readable when zoomed to 400%, with no horizontal scrolling for text blocks.
- **Order:** the reading order and keyboard focus order follow the visual order. Don't use layout tricks that place content visually in a different order from the code or the document structure.
- **Targets:** keep at least `space-2` between tappable items, and make buttons and controls at least 44 by 44px on all screens.
- **Print:** keep text out of the bleed and fold areas.

Do use generous white space and the `space-*` tokens to group related content.

Don't squeeze extra content in by shrinking margins, line spacing or text size.

Iconography

Icons help people find what they need quickly, including people who read English as a second language or find long text tiring. They only help if they are simple, consistent and always paired with words.

Our icon style

Our icons match the rounded, friendly character of the logo:

- **Outline style** with a **2px stroke** at 24px.
- **Rounded line ends and rounded corners**, like the wave lines in our symbol.
- Drawn on a **24px grid with 2px padding**, so the artwork sits inside a 20px live area.
- **Filled** versions only for a selected state (for example, the active tab in a menu).
- **Simple and literal**: one idea per icon, no tiny details, no text inside the icon.

Recommended icon set

Use **Lucide icons** (<https://lucide.dev>). Its rounded line ends, rounded joins and 2px stroke on a 24px grid match our style without changes. Lucide is free and open source under the ISC licence, which allows commercial use; keep the licence notice with any code that includes it.

If an icon is missing from Lucide, draw a new one in the same style (24px grid, 2px stroke, rounded ends and joins) and add it to the asset library. Don't mix icons from different sets in one design.

One icon per meaning

Use the same icon for the same idea everywhere, so people learn it once.

Meaning	Lucide icon
Housing and homes	house
Food and meals	utensils
Work and training	briefcase
Phone us	phone
Email us	mail
Find us / location	map-pin
Opening times	clock
Volunteering	hand-heart
Donate	heart
Information	info
Warning	triangle-alert
Error	circle-x
Success	circle-check

Avoid hand gestures (thumbs up, OK sign) and culturally specific symbols: their meaning varies across the communities we serve.

Sizes

Size	Use
16px	Inline with <code>small</code> text only, always next to a word
20px	Inline with <code>body</code> text, buttons and form fields
24px	Default: navigation, cards, lists
32px	Service tiles and feature lists
48px and up	Posters, leaflets and signage pictograms

Scale icons as whole units; don't change the stroke width. At 32px and above, the stroke scales with the icon. In print, keep icons at least 6mm high.

Colour

- Use `text-default` (`neutral-900`) or Harbour Blue on white and light backgrounds.
- Use white on Harbour Blue and on `neutral-950` backgrounds.
- Sunset Coral icons on white must use `secondary-500` or darker. Exact Sunset Coral and exact Tide Blue are below 3:1 on white, so use them only for decorative icons that add no information.
- Status icons use their state colour from chapter 04, always with a text label.
- Meaningful icons need at least 3:1 against their background.

Icon accessibility

- **Labels:** show a visible text label with every icon wherever there is room. Many of our readers will understand "Food" faster than a fork and knife.
- **Icon-only buttons** (for example, close or search) need an accessible name, such as `aria-label="Close"` , and a tooltip on hover and focus.
- **Decorative icons** next to a text label are hidden from screen readers (`aria-hidden="true"`), so the label isn't read twice.
- **Never use an icon alone for critical meaning**, such as an error, a deadline or a cost.
- **Target size:** the clickable area is at least 44 by 44px on all screens, even if the icon itself is smaller. This is stricter than the WCAG minimum of 24 by 24px because many of our users are older.

Do pair every icon with a short, plain word: "Call us", "Food", "Opening times".

Do use the same icon for the same meaning on the website, leaflets and social media.

Don't mix outline and filled icons, or icons from different sets, in one design.

Don't use exact Sunset Coral or Tide Blue for icons that carry meaning on white.

Photography and illustration

The people in our pictures are our neighbours. Every image we publish should show them with dignity, as capable people in their own community, never as objects of pity. That is how we earn the trust of families, volunteers, donors and partners alike.

Our photography style

- **Real people, real places:** families, volunteers and staff in Harbourside's streets, community spaces, kitchens and seafront, photographed with their consent.
- **Candid and warm:** people doing things together (cooking, talking, learning, moving into a new home), rather than posing for the camera.
- **Coastal light:** natural daylight, open skies and soft morning or evening light that echoes the rising sun in our logo.
- **Close and human:** eye-level framing, hands at work, shared moments. Leave calm space (sky, sea, a plain wall) where a headline or the logo can go.

Colour and treatment

- Grade gently towards warm, natural tones and clear blues. Never change skin tones to match brand colours.
- No heavy filters, duotones over faces, vignettes or artificial lens flare.
- Crop to the story, but never crop through people's joints or faces in a way that removes their identity or dignity.

Representation

Our community is diverse and our pictures should show it, without tokenism.

- Show a range of ages, with **older residents** as active, independent people, not only as recipients of help.
- Show different ethnicities, faiths, body types, genders and family shapes, as they really are in Harbourside.
- Show disabled people as active participants: volunteering, working, leading.
- Show volunteers and the people we support side by side, as equals. Avoid "helper and helped" compositions where one person looks down on another.
- Review a campaign's images together: does the set, as a whole, reflect the community?

Dignity and consent

These rules protect the people we work with. They are not optional.

- **Written consent** for every identifiable person, explained in plain language and, where needed, in their first language or with an interpreter. Consent forms must say where the image will be used and for how long.

- **Children** under 18 need consent from a parent or guardian. Don't publish a child's full name with their photo.
- **People can withdraw consent.** Remove their images from our channels promptly when asked, and keep a record.
- **Don't show identifying details** of anyone at risk: house numbers, street signs, car registrations, school uniforms or documents. Never identify anyone fleeing abuse or homelessness; use silhouettes, hands or backs instead.
- **No poverty images:** don't show empty cupboards, crying children, or people in distress to raise money. Show the change our support makes instead.
- *Proposed — confirm with the Communications team:* review consent for every image in the library every two years, and remove images whose consent has expired.

What to avoid

- Staged stock photos of people pointing at laptops or shaking hands.
- Images that don't look like Harbourside (for example, tropical beaches or city skyscrapers).
- Text baked into photos. Put text in the layout or the caption so it can be translated, read by screen readers and resized.
- Photos with logos or brands of other organisations in clear view, unless agreed with them.

Text over images

- Place text over a photo only on a solid panel (Harbour Blue with white text, or white with neutral-900 text) or over a dark scrim.
- If you use a scrim, check contrast at the lightest point behind the text: it must reach 4.5:1 for body text, or 3:1 for large text.
- Never place text over faces or busy detail.
- On social media, repeat any text in the image in the post copy and the alt text.

Illustration

Use illustration when photographs aren't suitable, for example for sensitive subjects or to explain a process.

- **Style:** simple, flat shapes with rounded corners and rounded line ends, matching our icons; a 2px line weight at 24px scale, scaled up in proportion.
- **Colour:** fills from the brand scales (Harbour Blue, Sunset Coral and Tide Blue tints) on white or light neutral backgrounds. Any lines or shapes that carry meaning must reach 3:1 against their background.
- **People:** friendly and simplified, with a range of skin tones, ages and abilities. Don't draw caricatures.
- **Commissioning:** brief illustrators with this chapter and the colour chapter, and own or license the artwork for all our channels.

Sourcing and rights

- **Our own photography first.** Brief photographers with this chapter and get model releases signed on the day.
- **Stock images** only from licensed libraries, and only when they look authentic and local. Check that the licence covers web, print and social media, and keep a copy of it.
- **Credit** photographers when the licence or agreement asks for it, in the format "Photo: Name".
- Store every image in the asset library with its consent form, licence, photographer and expiry date.

Alt text

- Describe the **purpose** of the image, not every detail: "Volunteers serving lunch at the Harbourside community kitchen."
- Keep it to about 125 characters. Put longer explanations in the caption or body text.
- Don't start with "Image of" or "Photo of".
- Name people only if they have consented to be named.
- Purely decorative images get empty alt text (`alt=""`).

AI-generated imagery

- **Never** use AI to create realistic images of the families, volunteers or staff we work with, or of anyone who looks like a real beneficiary. Our stories must be true.
- AI images may be used only for clearly illustrative or abstract graphics (for example, a background texture), approved by the Communications team.
- **Disclose** AI-generated images in the caption or credit ("Image created with AI"), and follow each social platform's labelling rules.
- Check AI images for bias, stereotypes and visual errors (hands, text, faces) before use.
- Don't use AI tools to edit real photographs in ways that change what happened, such as adding people or removing signs of hardship.

Do show people doing things together, in natural light, in places that look like Harbourside.

Don't use images of distress or poverty to make people feel guilty, or publish anyone's photo without their written consent.

Accessibility Every meaningful image needs alt text that explains why it is there, and no image should contain text that isn't also available as real text.

Data visualisation

Charts in our annual report, funding bids and reports to council partners show the difference our work makes. They must be accurate, easy to read at a glance and readable by everyone, including people who can't see colour differences and people using screen readers.

Choosing a chart

- **Bar charts** for comparing amounts (meals served per neighbourhood). Bars run horizontally when labels are long.
- **Line charts** for change over time (families housed each month).
- **A single big number** with a short sentence when there is only one figure to show.
- **Tables** when people need exact values.
- Avoid pie and doughnut charts with more than five slices, 3D charts, and dual axes.
- Always start bar chart axes at zero. Show the source and date of the data under every chart.

Series colours

Use colours in this order, so every chart in a report looks consistent:

Order	On white	On dark (neutral-950)
1	Harbour Blue (primary-700)	primary-500
2	secondary-500	Sunset Coral (secondary-400)
3	accent-600	accent-200
4	neutral-800	neutral-400

Every colour in this order reaches at least 3:1 against its background. We checked the set with colour-vision simulations and no pair was flagged as confusable. In greyscale, though, Harbour Blue and neutral-800 look similar, so add patterns or labels when charts may be printed in black and white.

- **Up to four series.** If you need more, split the chart into small multiples or use a table.
- **Highlight, then mute:** to make one point, show the key series in Harbour Blue and the others in neutral-500 .
- **Neighbouring colours don't reach 3:1 with each other**, so separate adjacent bars, stacked segments and slices with a 2px white gap (or a neutral-950 gap in dark mode).
- Don't use exact Tide Blue or exact Sunset Coral for marks on white; they are below 3:1. They may be used for background bands or highlight areas behind data.
- Never use the success, warning or error colours as series colours, and never use red and green as the only difference.

Labels, patterns and legends

- **Label directly:** put series names at the end of lines or next to bars instead of in a separate colour legend.
- **Patterns for print:** in printed reports, add a pattern (diagonal lines, dots) or a different marker shape (circle, square, triangle) to each series after the first.
- **Show the numbers:** label key values on bars or points so readers don't need to estimate.
- **Gridlines:** few and light, in `border-subtle`. They guide the eye but carry no meaning.

Typography in charts

- Use Atkinson Hyperlegible Next for all chart text.
- Labels at least 14px on screen (`small`) and 10pt in print (9pt only in partner reports). Titles use `h4` on screen.
- Use tabular figures, and format numbers, dates and currency as set out in chapter 12.
- Write chart titles as the key finding: "We served 20% more meals in winter" rather than "Meals by month". (This example is illustrative, not real data.)
- Keep all text horizontal; don't rotate axis labels.

Text alternatives

Every chart needs a text alternative, because a chart image is invisible to screen readers and hard to read for many people.

- **Alt text or caption** with three parts: the type of chart, what it shows, and the key takeaway. For example: "Bar chart of meals served in each neighbourhood in 2025. The harbour front served the most."
- **A data table** next to the chart or in an appendix, with a header row and units in the column headings.
- For council partners, provide the underlying data as a spreadsheet (CSV or XLSX) on request.
- In PDFs, tag charts as figures with alt text (chapter 17).

Do label data directly, show the source, and give every chart a plain-language takeaway.

Don't rely on a colour key alone, use 3D effects, or cut a bar chart's axis above zero.

Accessibility Chart marks need at least 3:1 against the background, and meaning must also be shown with labels, patterns or position, never colour alone.

Motion

Movement should feel like our logo: a calm tide and a slowly rising sun, never a jolt. We use motion only to help people understand what is happening, and we always respect people who need less of it.

Principles

- **Purposeful:** motion explains a change, such as a menu opening, a message appearing or a step completing. Never animate just to decorate.
- **Gentle and quick:** short movements with a soft ease-out, so things settle into place like water coming to rest. No bouncing, except a single small overshoot for a celebration (for example, "Thank you for your donation").
- **Consistent direction:** things enter from where they will be and leave the way they came. Panels slide from the side they are attached to; messages rise up gently from the bottom.
- **Small distances:** move items by no more than `space-5` to `space-6` . Large sweeps across the screen are tiring and can cause motion sickness.

Durations and easing

Motion tokens

Token	Value
duration-instant	0ms
duration-fast	120ms
duration-base	200ms
duration-slow	320ms
duration-deliberate	500ms
ease-standard	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)
ease-enter	cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0, 1)
ease-exit	cubic-bezier(0.3, 0, 1, 1)

Reduced motion: When `prefers-reduced-motion` is set, replace movement with fades of 120ms or less, and stop parallax, auto-advancing carousels and looping animation.

Interaction	Duration	Easing
Hover, focus and pressed states	duration-fast	ease-standard
Toggles, tabs, small menus	duration-base	ease-standard
Items appearing (messages, dropdowns, cards)	duration-base to duration-slow	ease-enter
Items leaving	duration-fast to duration-base	ease-exit
Dialogs and side panels	duration-slow	ease-enter in, ease-exit out
Page transitions and large panels	duration-deliberate at most	ease-standard

Exits are faster than entrances: people have already decided to move on.

Logo animation

Proposed — confirm with the Communications team: a short logo sting for video, in which the sun rises gently from behind the waves, then the wordmark fades in.

- Lasts no more than 3 seconds and ends on the static, approved logo, held for at least 1 second.
- Never stretches, spins, bounces or distorts the logo, or changes its colours.
- Uses vector artwork prepared by a designer, not the PNG.
- Plays once. Never loops.

Video intros and outros

- **Intro:** no more than 3 seconds of branding before the content starts. On social media, start with the story, not the logo.
- **Outro (end card):** the logo on white (full colour) or on Harbour Blue (reversed), with our website address and a call to action in text, held for 3 to 5 seconds.
- **Captions** on every video, with our type styles from chapter 05, and lower thirds kept inside the platform's safe zone (chapter 15).

Motion accessibility

- **Reduced motion:** honour the `prefers-reduced-motion` setting. Replace movement with short fades, as set out in the reduced-motion rule above, and stop parallax, looping animation and auto-advancing carousels.
- **No flashing:** nothing may flash more than three times in any one second.

- **Pause, stop, hide:** anything that moves, scrolls or updates automatically for more than 5 seconds needs a visible pause or stop button.
- **No autoplaying sound.** Videos start muted, with captions on.
- **Avoid parallax, large zooms and full-screen sweeps,** which can trigger dizziness and nausea.
- **Captions and transcripts** for all video and audio content.

Do use short, soft ease-out movements that explain a change on screen.

Don't autoplay video with sound, loop animations endlessly, or animate the logo in ways that distort it.

Voice and tone

The people who read our words may be worried about rent, food or work. Some are older, and many speak English as a second language. Our voice must make them feel welcome, respected and sure of what to do next.

Our **voice** is who we are, and it stays the same everywhere. Our **tone** changes with the situation, the way a kind neighbour speaks differently at a party and at a hospital bedside.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: the voice attributes, tone settings and word list below. They are built from our mission, our four values and the personality in chapter 2.

Voice attributes

We have four voice attributes. Each one links to a personality trait in chapter 2.

1. Warm, not sentimental

We are	We are not
Friendly, kind and welcoming. We talk to people as equals.	Gushing, pitying or dramatic. We never make people feel like a "case".

Example: "Come along on Tuesday. We will make you a cup of tea, and someone will help you with the form."

2. Clear and simple, not childish

We are	We are not
Plain, direct and easy to translate. We use short sentences and everyday words.	Babyish, vague or full of jargon. Simple words do not mean simple ideas.

Example: "You can get a food parcel if you live in Harbourside. Bring something with your address on it, such as a letter."

3. Calm and steady, not cold

We are	We are not
Reassuring and reliable. We say what will happen next.	Formal, distant or alarmed. We do not use official-sounding phrases or shout in capitals.

Example: "If you are worried about losing your home, call us. We will listen, and we will help you work out your next step."

4. Hopeful and honest, not over-promising

We are	We are not
Positive about what people can do together. Open about what we can and cannot do.	Promising outcomes we cannot guarantee. Exaggerating need or results.

Example: "We cannot find everyone a home straight away. But we will stay with you while you look."

Do read your words aloud. If they sound like a friendly person from Harbourside, the voice is right.

Don't borrow the voice of a bank, a council letter or a fundraising advert. We are none of those.

Tone by context

Use this table to set your tone. The dials show where to sit for each situation:

- **Formality:** formal ↔ casual
- **Mood:** serious ↔ light

Situation	Formality	Mood	Example	Words to avoid
Fundraising and campaigns	Mid-casual	Mid-light, hopeful	"£10 helps us cook warm meals for families in Harbourside. Give if you can."	"Desperate", "shocking", "only you can", "before it's too late"
Website	Mid	Mid	"Need help with food? Here is how to get a food parcel this week."	"Service users", "beneficiaries", "eligibility criteria apply"
Forms, buttons and messages (microcopy)	Mid-casual	Neutral	Button: "Book a place". Hint: "We only use your phone number to contact you about this."	"Submit", "Invalid", "Required field" with no explanation
Support for families	Mid-casual	Serious and warm	"Thank you for telling us. We can help. Here is what happens next."	"Unfortunately", "As per", "You must" without a reason
Error messages	Mid	Neutral, calm	"We could not send your form. Check your internet connection and try again, or call us."	"Error 500", "Something went wrong" with no next step, "You entered" (blame)
Bad news and crisis	Mid-formal	Serious	"Our Tuesday food club is closed this week because of flooding. Your nearest open point is [place, time]."	Jokes, emoji, "We regret to inform you", guesses about cause or blame
Social posts	Casual	Light to mid	"Thank you to everyone who helped at Saturday's community lunch. 60 hot meals served."	Idioms, slang, more than 3 hashtags, emoji in the middle of sentences

Situation	Formality	Mood	Example	Words to avoid
Social replies and complaints	Mid-casual	Serious and kind	"We're sorry this happened. Please message us privately so we can put it right."	Arguing in public, copy-and-paste replies, asking for personal details in public
Volunteer recruitment	Casual	Light, welcoming	"Do you have two hours a week? Help us pack food boxes on Thursday mornings. No experience needed."	"Rockstar", "ninja", "must be young and energetic"
Council partners, legal and funders	Formal	Serious	"We propose a joint drop-in for housing advice. We have set out the costs below."	Unsupported claims, jargon without definitions, "world-class"
Internal communications	Casual	Mid	"Quick update: the warm-space rota for November is now on the shared drive."	Acronyms nobody has defined, blame

The figure "60 hot meals" in the social example shows the format only. Always use real, checked numbers.

Note We are a charity, not a company, so we have no investors. Write to funders, grant-makers and the council with the "Council partners, legal and funders" tone.

Crisis and bad news checklist

When something goes wrong, people need facts fast. Follow these steps:

1. Say what has happened in the first sentence.
2. Say what it means for the reader.
3. Say what they should do now, and where to get help.
4. Say when we will update them.
5. Get approval from the Communications team before you post.

Don't use humour, emoji or campaign hashtags during a crisis or when someone has made a complaint.

Writing about people and money

Our audiences include people who are struggling and people who are giving. Both deserve respect.

- **Dignity first.** Describe a situation, not a person: "families who need help with food", not "the needy".
- **No guilt.** Ask donors to give because they can make a difference, not because they should feel bad.
- **Real stories need real consent.** Only share a person's story, name or photo with their written consent. Tell them where it will appear and for how long. They can change their mind at any time. Chapter 12 has the full rules.

Do show people as active: "Amira found a job through our work club." (Use real names only with consent.)

Don't show people as helpless: "Poor Amira had nowhere to turn until we rescued her."

Before and after

These rewrites show the voice in our own work. The "after" versions use shorter sentences, everyday words and a clear next step.

Before	After	Why
"Service users meeting the eligibility criteria may access emergency food provision via referral."	"If you need food this week, we can help. Call us or visit any Tuesday from 10am to 12pm."	Plain words, a direct "you", and a clear action
"Without YOUR help, these desperate families will go hungry this winter."	"This winter, £15 helps a family in Harbourside share a warm meal. Will you help?"	Hopeful, not guilt-based; no capitals for emphasis
"We are thrilled to announce our exciting new partnership synergy with the council!"	"We are working with the council to give housing advice at our Tuesday drop-in."	Says what is happening, without hype
"Volunteers are needed ASAP to help the less fortunate. Get stuck in!"	"We need volunteers to pack food boxes on Thursday mornings. Can you give two hours?"	No idioms, no pitying labels, a specific request
"Your application could not be processed due to missing information."	"We need one more thing: a letter with your address on it. You can bring it to us or send a photo on WhatsApp."	Calm, active and tells the reader exactly what to do

The times, amounts and services in these examples show the style only. Check every real detail with the Communications team before you publish.

Words we use and avoid

We say	We avoid	Why
families, people, neighbours, residents	the needy, the poor, the less fortunate, service users, clients	Labels take away dignity
people on a low income	poor people, deprived people	Describes a situation, not a person
people who are homeless, people without a safe home	the homeless, vagrants, rough sleepers (as a label)	People first
food parcel, food support	handouts, charity hand-out, freebies	"Handout" suggests a favour, not support
people claiming benefits, people getting Universal Credit	benefit scroungers, welfare dependants, on the dole	Stigmatising and untrue
help, support, work with	rescue, save, give a voice to	People are not helpless
give, donate	"only you can save", "before it's too late"	No guilt or false urgency
volunteer	helper (as a lesser term)	Volunteers are equal members of the team
the council, our council partners	the authorities	Warmer and specific

Accessibility Use the same word for the same thing every time. If you call it a "food parcel" on the poster, do not call it a "food box" on the website. Readers using translation tools and readers with English as a second language rely on this.

Writing style

Consistent, plain writing helps people trust us and act on what we say. Many of our readers are older residents or speak English as a second language. If a sentence is easy for them, it is easy for everyone.

These rules apply to everything we publish: leaflets, posters, the website, social posts, WhatsApp messages, emails, letters and reports.

Plain English comes first

Plain English is our most important writing rule. When another rule in this chapter conflicts with it, plain English wins.

Our targets

Measure	Target
Reading age for public content	9 to 11 years (UK)
Average sentence length	15 words or fewer
Longest sentence	25 words
Ideas per sentence	One
Paragraph length	3 sentences or fewer on screen

Council partner reports and funding bids can go a little higher, but aim for a reading age of 12 to 14 and still define every technical term.

How to write plainly

- **Put the most important thing first.** Start with what the reader needs to know or do.
- **Use the active voice.** "We will call you on Monday", not "You will be contacted on Monday".
- **Talk to the reader as "you".** Speak as "we" for Harbourside Community Trust.
- **Use everyday words.** "Help", not "assist". "Use", not "utilise". "About", not "approximately". "Get", not "obtain". "Start", not "commence".
- **Use the same word for the same thing.** Do not switch between "food parcel", "food box" and "food bag".
- **Explain what will happen next,** and how long it will take.
- **Test your writing.** Read it aloud. Use a readability checker for long pages. Best of all, ask a local resident to read it.

Avoid idioms and figures of speech

Idioms are phrases that do not mean what the words say. They confuse readers with English as a second language and do not translate well.

Avoid	Write instead
"We've got your back"	"We will support you"
"Get stuck in"	"Join in" or "Help us"
"Make ends meet"	"Pay for the things you need"
"On the breadline"	"On a low income"
"Keep a roof over your head"	"Stay in your home"
"Drop us a line"	"Email us" or "Call us"
"Hit the ground running"	"Start straight away"

Define terms

If you must use a technical word, explain it the first time, in plain words. For example: "Universal Credit is a payment from the government to help with living costs."

Do write: "Bring a letter with your address on it, such as a gas or electricity bill."

Don't write: "Proof of residency documentation must be provided at point of access."

Translations and Easy Read

Many families in Harbourside read English as a second language. Plan for this from the start.

- **Write the English version plainly first.** Plain English is quicker, cheaper and more accurate to translate.
- **Use professional or community-checked translations** for important information about homes, food, money or safety. Do not rely only on automatic translation for these.
- **Avoid text in images.** Translation tools and screen readers cannot read it. Put the words in the post or on the page.
- **Leave space in layouts.** Some languages need up to 30% more space than English.
- **Offer Easy Read versions** of key information, such as how to get help. Easy Read uses very short sentences, one idea per line and a clear picture beside each idea.
- **Show which languages are available** in each language's own name and script, not only in English.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: which community languages we translate into. We do not yet have this list. Ask families and partners which languages are most needed.

Inclusive and dignity-first language

We describe people with respect. Every family we work with is a neighbour, not a problem to solve.

Poverty, housing and food

- Describe the situation, not the person: "families on a low income", "people who are homeless", "people who need help with food".
- Do not use "the needy", "the poor", "the less fortunate", "handouts", "benefit scroungers" or "deprived families".
- Do not use words of pity: "poor", "desperate", "helpless", "suffering", "pitiful", "victims".
- Show people as active and capable: "Sam is looking for work", not "Sam is unemployed and struggling".
- Do not describe a person's home, clothes or appearance unless it is essential and they agree.

Disability, age, gender and culture

- Follow how people describe themselves. In the UK, "disabled people" (identity-first) is widely preferred. Some people prefer "people with a disability". Ask, and follow their choice.
- Do not use "suffers from", "wheelchair-bound", "the disabled" or "normal" (meaning not disabled).
- Avoid disability metaphors: "blind spot", "falling on deaf ears", "crippling costs", "lame", "crazy". Write "gap", "ignored", "very high costs" instead.
- Use gender-neutral words: "they", "everyone", "parents and carers", "chair", "staff".
- Say "older people" or "older residents", not "the elderly", "pensioners" (as a label) or "OAPs".
- Do not mention someone's age, race, religion, nationality, immigration status or health unless it is relevant and they agree.
- Avoid sports, military and festival-specific idioms that not everyone shares.

Do write: "Parents and carers can bring children to the warm meal."

Don't write: "Mums can bring the kids along."

Stories, consent and personal data

Stories help people understand our work. They also involve personal data, which the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) protects.

- **Get written consent** before you use anyone's name, photo, voice, story or quotes. For children under 18, get consent from a parent or carer, and ask the child too.
- **Explain clearly** where the story will appear (for example, Facebook, the website, a leaflet), for how long, and that it may be shared further online.

- **Make it easy to say no** and to change their mind later. Tell them how: "Email comms@harbourside.example and we will remove it."
- **Change names and details** when someone wants to stay anonymous. Say so: "Name changed to protect privacy."
- **Never share** addresses, health details, immigration status or details that could identify someone without clear, specific consent.
- **Do not ask for personal details in public** social comments. Move the conversation to a private message.
- **Keep consent records** with the Communications team.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: the consent form, how long stories stay published and how long consent records are kept. These need checking against the organisation's data protection policy.

Asking for donations

We ask people to give because they can make a positive difference, never because they should feel guilty.

- Be honest about what money pays for. Use only real, checked figures.
- Say "Give if you can". Never say "Only you can save" or "before it's too late" unless a real deadline exists.
- Do not use shocking or pitying descriptions of families.
- Make it just as easy to stop a regular gift as to start one.
- Ask before adding people to email or WhatsApp lists, and say how often we will contact them.

Our name

Use	Example
Full name, first mention	Harbourside Community Trust
Short name, after first mention	the Trust
Possessive	Harbourside Community Trust's volunteers
Verb agreement	Singular: "Harbourside Community Trust is a local charity."

- Write the full name the first time on every page, post or document.
- After that, you may write "the Trust" (lower-case "the", capital "T"), or "we".
- Do not shorten the name to "HCT" in public content. If a partner document needs an abbreviation, write the full name first with the abbreviation in brackets.
- Do not split or restyle the name: never "Harbour Side", "HarbourSide" or all capitals.
- Write "Harbourside" (one word, capital H) for the place too.

Spelling, grammar and punctuation

Topic	Our rule
Spelling	British English (en-GB): colour, organisation, centre, neighbour, programme (an event)
Dictionary	<i>Proposed — confirm with leadership:</i> Oxford English Dictionary or Collins
"-ise" or "-ize"	Use "-ise": organise, recognise
Serial (Oxford) comma	Do not use it by default, as in our mission: "safe homes, warm meals and good work". Add it only when a list would be unclear without it
Quotation marks	Single 'quotes'; double "quotes" inside quotes
Dashes	Avoid dashes in public content: use two sentences instead. In tables and ranges, use an en dash (10–20)
Exclamation marks	One at most, and only for real good news. Never in serious or bad news
Contractions	Use common ones ("we're", "you'll") in casual content. Use full forms ("do not", "cannot") in instructions and translated content, as they are clearer
Brackets and semicolons	Use rarely. Start a new sentence instead
Ampersands (&)	Do not use in body text. Write "and"

Capitalisation

- Use **sentence case** for headings, buttons, menus, labels, email subjects and posters: "Get help with food", not "Get Help With Food".
- Capitalise names, places and our four values: Kindness, Fairness, Together, Local first.
- Capitalise job titles only before a name: "Volunteer Coordinator Jo Smith", but "our volunteer coordinator".
- Never use ALL CAPS for words or sentences. It is harder to read, and some screen readers spell it out letter by letter.

Numbers, dates, times and money

Topic	Our rule	Example
Numbers	Words for one to nine; numerals for 10 and above. Always numerals for money, percentages, ages and data	three volunteers, 12 families, 5%
Large numbers	Use commas from 1,000	1,250; 2.5 million
Percentages	Numeral and % sign. In public content, a fraction may be clearer	25%, or "one in four"
Dates	Day, month, year. Add the weekday for events	Tuesday 6 October 2026
Times	12-hour clock, no ":00", "am" and "pm" with no full stops	10am to 12pm, 2:30pm
Midday and midnight	Write words to avoid confusion	midday, midnight
Time ranges	"to", not a dash, in prose	10am to 1pm
Money	£ sign, no ".00"	£5, £12.50
Free	Say "free", not "£0" or "complimentary"	free hot meal
Phone numbers	Spaces in groups, with the area code	01632 960 000
Addresses	One line per part on posters and leaflets; commas in a sentence, no full stops at line ends	Community Centre, Harbour Road, Harbourside

The phone number and address shown are format examples only. Use the organisation's real details.

Accessibility Do not use dates in numbers only (06/10/26). They mean different dates in different countries and are hard for screen readers.

Abbreviations and acronyms

- Avoid abbreviations in public content.
- If you must use one, write it in full first, then the short form in brackets: "Department for Work and Pensions (DWP)". After that, the short form is fine.
- Do not use "e.g.", "i.e." or "etc." Write "for example", "that is" or "and more".
- Do not use full stops in acronyms: "UK", "GDPR".

Links and calls to action

- Link text must say where it goes: "Find a food parcel near you", not "click here" or "read more".
- Start buttons with a verb: "Book a place", "Give now", "Sign up to volunteer".
- Say if a link opens a file, and give its type and size: "Winter help leaflet (PDF, 1 MB)".
- Use only one main call to action in each message.
- Give a way to act without the internet, such as a phone number or a place to visit.

Lists

- Use bullet lists for three or more items. Use numbered lists for steps in order.
- Introduce the list with a short sentence.
- Start each item with a capital letter. Use a full stop only if the item is a full sentence.
- Keep lists to seven items or fewer.

Accessible content

- **Use meaningful headings** in order, so people can scan the page and screen-reader users can jump between sections.
- **Do not rely on colour, shape or position.** Write "Select 'Book a place'", not "Click the coral button on the right".
- **Write alt text for every meaningful image.** Describe what matters in the context: "A volunteer hands a food parcel to a smiling father at our community centre."
- **Put the words in the text**, not inside an image.
- **Hashtags:** write them in CamelCase, such as #HereForHarbourside, so screen readers read each word. Use no more than three in a post, and put them at the end.
- **Emoji:** use one or two at most, at the end of a sentence. Never use emoji to replace words, and never use them in serious or bad news.
- **Do not use "fancy" Unicode letters** (**bold** or *italic* text). Screen readers cannot read them.
- **Caption every video**, and give a transcript for audio.

Do write: "Read our guide to help with energy bills (PDF, 400 KB)."

Don't write: "Click here for help 🙌🙌 #energybills #cost #help #harbourside #winter"

Quick checklist before you publish

1. Is the most important information first?
2. Are sentences 25 words or fewer, with no idioms?
3. Have you described people with dignity and checked consent?
4. Is every fact, number and date checked?
5. Do links and buttons say what they do?
6. Is there a way to get help without the internet?

7. Has someone else read it?

Accessibility

Many of the people we serve are older residents. Many others speak English as a second language, have a disability, or rarely go online. If they cannot read, hear or use something we make, we have not helped them. Accessibility is part of being kind, fair and local first, so this chapter applies to everyone who makes anything for Harbourside Community Trust.

Our commitment

Everything we publish meets **WCAG 2.2 level AA**. That includes our website, Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn and WhatsApp posts, documents and PDFs, letters, posters, signs, videos and events. Where this chapter sets a higher bar than AA, such as larger touch targets or larger print, we follow the higher bar because of who our audiences are.

We always offer a way to get help that does not need the internet. Every leaflet, post, page and letter that asks people to do something also gives a phone number or an in-person option.

The law in the UK

- **Equality Act 2010:** as a service provider, we must make reasonable adjustments for disabled people. We should plan for them in advance, not only when someone asks. This applies to us now.
- **Public Sector Bodies (Websites and Mobile Applications) (No. 2) Accessibility Regulations 2018:** these apply to our council partners. Charities are usually exempt. They can apply to a charity that is mostly publicly funded, or that provides services which are essential to the public or aimed mainly at disabled people. *Proposed — confirm with the trustees whether they apply to us.* Either way, council contracts may require us to meet WCAG 2.2 AA and publish an accessibility statement, and we do both.

Note We publish an accessibility statement on our website. It says how well the site meets WCAG 2.2 AA, lists known problems, and explains how to report a problem or ask for another format. The Communications team reviews it every 12 months.

Colour and contrast

Contrast is the difference in brightness between text and its background. Many older readers find low contrast hard to read, especially in daylight or on a cracked phone screen.

What	Minimum contrast	WCAG 2.2
Text under 24px (or under 18.66px bold)	4.5:1	1.4.3
Large text, 24px or more (or 18.66px bold or more)	3:1	1.4.3
Buttons, form borders, icons that carry meaning, chart lines and bars	3:1 against what is next to them	1.4.11
Focus indicators	3:1, at least 2px thick	1.4.11, 2.4.7

The approved colour pairings are listed in the Colour chapter (chapter 4). Use those first. Our brand colours behave differently:

- **Harbour Blue** passes for text of any size on white.
- **Sunset Coral** is 2.95:1 on white. Use it only for decoration and large shapes. For coral text, links or icons on white, use `secondary-600`.
- **Tide Blue** is 1.77:1 on white. Use it only for decoration and backgrounds behind dark text. For text, use `accent-600`.

The full-colour logo on white is an approved exception, because logos are exempt from the contrast rule. "Community Trust" in Sunset Coral is hard for some people to read, so the logo must never be the only place our name appears. Always write "Harbourside Community Trust" in real text nearby, for example in the page title, the first line of a post or the letter heading.

Checking a new combination

1. Look for the pairing in chapter 4.
2. If it is not there, check it with any WCAG contrast checker, such as the WebAIM Contrast Checker.
3. The brand team can also run `contrast_check.py FG BG --use body` (or `--use large`, or `--use ui`). The script fails any pairing below the threshold.
4. Ask the Communications team to add new approved pairings to the brand data. Do not use an unapproved pairing in the meantime.

For text over photos, put the text on a solid panel or a dark scrim. Measure the contrast against the busiest, lightest part of the photo, not the average.

Do use `secondary-600` for coral text and Harbour Blue for links on white backgrounds.

Don't set text in Sunset Coral or Tide Blue on white, even in headlines.

Do not rely on colour alone

About 1 in 12 men and 1 in 200 women see colour differently. Others print in black and white or use high-contrast settings. Colour must never be the only way to show something (WCAG 1.4.1).

- **Links in body text** are always underlined.
- **Errors, warnings and success messages** have an icon and a text label, such as "Error: enter your postcode". Keep Sunset Coral out of error messages: it looks like the error colour. Keep Harbour Blue and Tide Blue out of information messages for the same reason.
- **States** such as selected, required or unavailable are shown in words or with an icon as well as with colour.
- **Charts and maps** label each series or area directly, or use patterns and different line styles. Success, warning and error colours look alike to many people with colour-vision deficiency, and so do Sunset Coral and the success green. Never let a reader tell these apart by colour alone. See Data visualisation (chapter 9).

Don't write "the items in red are full". Write "Full" next to each item.

Typography

Our body typeface, Atkinson Hyperlegible Next, was designed for people with low vision. Its letters, such as I, l and 1, are easy to tell apart. Set it well, or the benefit is lost.

Medium	Body text	Notes
Web and apps	body (16px) minimum. Use body-lg (20px) for pages aimed at older residents	Nothing below 14px (small), and only for captions and legal lines
Social images	Text at least 4% of the image height (54px on a 1080 × 1350 post)	Repeat the words in the caption
Letters and leaflets for the public	14pt minimum	12pt only for partner and internal reports
Large print	16pt minimum	Supply on request, and offer it by default at events for older people
Posters and signs	Readable from the expected viewing distance	See Environment and merchandise (chapter 18)

- Line height at least 1.5 for body text, with paragraph spacing at least 1.5 times the text size.
- Lines of 45–75 characters.

- Text is left-aligned and **never justified**. Justified text creates uneven gaps that make reading harder for people with dyslexia.
- Write headings in sentence case. Do not set more than a few words in capitals, and do not put whole paragraphs in italics or light weights.
- Pages must work when people zoom to 200% and when the screen is 320px wide, with nothing cut off and no sideways scrolling (WCAG 1.4.4, 1.4.10). Layouts must cope when people increase letter, word and line spacing (1.4.12).
- Do not use pictures of text, except the logo (1.4.5).

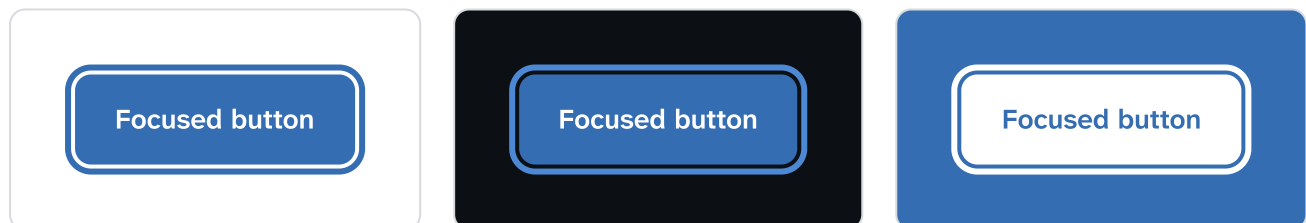
Plain English, Easy Read and translations

Write for a reading age of 9 to 11. Use short sentences, common words and the active voice. Avoid idioms such as "touch base" or "in the same boat", which do not translate and confuse readers new to English. Explain any acronym the first time you use it.

- Produce **Easy Read** versions of important information, such as how to get help with housing, food or work. Easy Read uses short sentences, each paired with a supporting picture.
- Offer **translations** of key information. *Proposed — confirm the community languages with frontline staff.* Use professional or community-checked translations, not unchecked machine translation. On the web, mark the language of a translated page or passage in the code (WCAG 3.1.1, 3.1.2).
- Always put a text label with an icon. An icon alone can mean different things to different people.

Focus and interaction

The focus indicator shows keyboard users where they are on a page. Never remove it. Our focus style, including the colours to use on brand-colour backgrounds and in dark mode:



Focus indicator

Property	Value	Check
Focus colour on light surfaces	 #356db2	5.27:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour on dark surfaces	 #4c88d3	5.24:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Harbour Blue sections	 #ffffff	5.27:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Sunset Coral sections	 #0c1015	3.30:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Tide Blue sections	 #0c1015	3.67:1 — Pass ✓
Outline width	3px	At least 2px (WCAG 2.4.13 guidance)
Offset from element	2px	

- Everything that works with a mouse must also work with a keyboard alone. Keyboard focus must never get stuck (2.1.1, 2.1.2).
- Focus moves in a logical order and is never hidden behind sticky headers or cookie banners (2.4.3, 2.4.11).
- **Targets:** WCAG requires at least 24 by 24px (2.5.8). Because many of our users have tremor or limited dexterity, **we make every button and standalone control at least 44 by 44px**, with space between them. Inline text links cannot be that size, so give them generous line spacing (at least 1.5) and keep them apart from other links.
- Do not make people drag, swipe or use two fingers. Offer a simple tap or click instead (2.5.1, 2.5.7).
- **No time limits** on forms or content. If a time limit is unavoidable, warn people and let them extend it (2.2.1).
- Forms have visible labels, give instructions before the field, explain errors in words, and do not ask for the same information twice (3.3.1, 3.3.2, 3.3.7). Do not make people solve puzzles or remember passwords to sign in (3.3.8).
- Put help in the same place on every page: our phone number and email address, as well as any online option (3.2.6).
- Link text says where the link goes, for example "Find a warm meal near you". Never use "click here" or "read more".

Images

Every meaningful image needs alt text: a short description that screen readers read aloud (WCAG 1.1.1). Describe what matters for the purpose of the image, in about 125 characters or fewer. Do not start with "Image of" or "Photo of".

Type	What to write	Example
Informative	What the image shows that matters	"Volunteers serve hot soup to families at the Harbourside community kitchen."
Functional (a link or button)	Where it goes or what it does	A phone icon linking to our helpline: "Call our helpline"
Decorative	Nothing. Use <code>alt=""</code> on the web and leave the alt field empty on social media	A wave pattern behind a heading
Complex (charts, maps, infographics)	A short summary, plus the full information in text or a table nearby	"Bar chart: meals served rose each month from January to June. Full figures in the table below."
Text in an image	The same words as the image	A poster that says "Free lunch, Saturday 12 till 2": write exactly that

Logo alt text: "Harbourside Community Trust logo". When the logo links to the home page, use "Harbourside Community Trust home".

Do describe people by what they are doing, not what they look like, unless their appearance is the point of the image.

Don't put important information only in an image. Repeat it in the text or caption.

Video and audio

- **Captions** on every video, checked by a person for accuracy and speaker names (1.2.2). Automatic captions are a starting point, not a finished job. For social media, burn captions into the video as well, because many people watch with the sound off.
- **Transcripts** for every audio clip, podcast and WhatsApp voice note we send to groups.
- **Audio description**, or a described transcript, when important information is shown but not said (1.2.5). The easiest fix is to say it out loud: "You'll see our address on screen: ...".
- **No autoplay with sound.** Videos on our website do not play until someone presses play.
- Speak clearly, with background music kept low, so people with hearing loss can follow.

Motion

- Respect the device's "reduce motion" setting. When it is on, replace movement with fades of 120ms or less, and stop parallax, auto-advancing carousels and looping animation. See Motion (chapter 10).
- Nothing flashes more than three times a second (2.3.1). This includes GIFs on social media.
- Anything that moves, scrolls or updates by itself for more than five seconds has a pause or stop control (2.2.2).

Documents, PDFs and letters

Most of our documents are read by people using screen readers, magnifiers or printouts. Build accessibility in from the start, using the templates in Presentations and documents (chapter 17).

- Use the built-in **heading styles** (Heading 1, Heading 2) in order, real bulleted and numbered lists, and tables with a header row. Do not use empty lines or spaces to create layout.
- Set the document **title and language** (English (United Kingdom)) in the file properties.
- Add alt text to images and mark decorative images as decorative.
- Make the **reading order** logical: check it in the Word or PowerPoint selection pane.
- Run the **Accessibility Checker** in Microsoft Word or PowerPoint and fix every error before you share or export.
- Export **tagged PDFs** (in Word, "Save as PDF" with document structure tags turned on). Add bookmarks to anything over 10 pages. Check the PDF with PAC (PDF Accessibility Checker) or Adobe Acrobat's accessibility check.
- For information on the website, publish a web page rather than a PDF. If you must use a PDF, also offer the content in Word or as a web page.
- **Letters** use the body font at 14pt minimum, left-aligned, on white or cream paper, not glossy. Put the most important information, and our phone number, at the top. Offer large print, Easy Read, audio and other languages, and record people's format preferences so we use them every time.

Don't scan a printed page and share it as a PDF. A scanned page is a picture, so screen readers cannot read the text.

Social media and WhatsApp

The Social media chapter (chapter 15) has the full rules and its own accessibility section. The essentials:

- Add alt text to every image in the platform's alt text field on Facebook, Instagram and LinkedIn.
- WhatsApp has no alt text field, so describe important images in the message text.
- Caption every video and burn the captions in.
- Write hashtags in CamelCase, for example #HarboursideTrust, and put no more than three at the end.
- Use emoji sparingly, at the end of a sentence, and never in place of words. Screen readers read out every emoji name.
- Never use "fancy" Unicode letters for bold or italic effects. Screen readers cannot read them.
- Put any words that appear in an image in the post text as well.

Events and physical spaces

Our events must welcome older residents, disabled people and families with young children.

- **Before booking a venue**, check for step-free access to the entrance, main room and an accessible toilet. Check for a hearing loop, good lighting, seating with backs and arms, and accessible parking or a nearby bus stop.
- **In every invitation**, describe the access (for example, "Step-free entrance from the main car park. Hearing loop in the main hall"). Give a phone number and email address for asking for adjustments, and a date to ask by. Do not invite people by social media or online forms alone.
- **On request**, provide **British Sign Language (BSL)** interpreters and live captioning by a speech-to-text reporter (CART). Book them at least four weeks ahead, as they are in short supply.
- Have **large print** copies of anything handed out, and a printed agenda.
- Offer a **quiet space** away from the main room, and a clear way to leave.
- Speakers use a microphone every time, including for questions from the floor, so the hearing loop works.
- Signs use the brand's high-contrast pairings, large text and simple words, with symbols plus words.

Testing and sign-off

Automated tools find only some problems. Test every new web page, template, campaign and important document in these ways.

1. **Automated:** run axe DevTools, WAVE or Lighthouse on web pages, and the Microsoft or PAC checker on documents.
2. **Keyboard:** use Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter and Space to reach and use everything. Focus must always be visible.
3. **Screen reader:** NVDA on Windows, VoiceOver on iPhone or Mac, and TalkBack on Android. Check headings, links, alt text, form labels and reading order.
4. **Zoom and reflow:** zoom to 200% and 400%, or use a 320px-wide screen. Nothing should be cut off or overlap.
5. **Colour:** check contrast for any new pairing, and view the design in greyscale to confirm nothing depends on colour.
6. **Plain English:** read the copy aloud, or run it through a readability checker, and aim for a reading age of 9 to 11.
7. **Real people:** test important services and campaigns with the people who will use them. Include older residents, disabled people and people who speak English as a second language. Pay them or offer vouchers for their time, and test both online and offline routes.

Sign-off: the person who made the work completes the checks. The Communications team gives final approval before anything is published. Anything that fails a contrast, alt text, caption or keyboard check is not published until it is fixed. *Proposed — confirm a named accessibility lead within the Communications team.*

Accessibility If you are not sure whether something is accessible, ask before you publish, not after.

Getting help and accessible formats

Anyone can ask for our information in another format, such as large print, Easy Read, audio, Braille, another language, or a phone call. They can also report something that is hard to use.

- Email comms@harbourside.example
- Phone: *Proposed — add the main phone number*
- Or speak to any member of staff or volunteer, who will pass the request on.

We aim to reply within five working days. *Proposed — confirm this response time*. Put this route, including a phone option, on our website footer, the accessibility statement and printed materials.

Digital and web

Our website, emails and videos are often the first place a family, volunteer or council officer meets us, and many read them on an older phone, with larger text turned on, or in their second language. Every digital touchpoint must feel calm and welcoming like the logo, and work for everyone first time.

Website header and footer

- **Header:** place the full-colour primary logo top left on a white header, at least 160px wide on desktop and never below the 160px minimum on mobile. If a narrow screen cannot fit 160px alongside the menu button, switch to the symbol at 40px or more, followed by the organisation's name as live text.
- **Link:** the logo links to the home page. Its alt text is "Harbourside Community Trust home", not "logo" and not the file name.
- **Clear space:** keep the clear space from chapter 03 (the height of the sun) on every side, including from the menu.
- **Footer:** use a `surface-inverse` or Harbour Blue footer with the single-colour light logo, or a white footer with the full-colour logo. Never put the full-colour logo on `surface-subtle` or any light grey: the full-colour exception covers white only. Use the single-colour dark logo there instead.
- **Footer content:** include "[Registered charity number]", "[Registered address]", a contact link, the accessibility statement and the privacy notice. Do not leave these as images.

Do show the name "Harbourside Community Trust" as live text in the page title and footer, so it is never only inside the logo image.

Don't use a transparent full-colour logo in a dark-mode header; Harbour Blue disappears on dark backgrounds. Swap in the single-colour light logo.

Buttons and links

Element	Style	Notes
Primary button	<code>surface-brand</code> fill with <code>text-on-brand</code> label, <code>label</code> type token, radius <code>md</code>	One per view, for the main action ("Get help", "Volunteer", "Donate")
Secondary button	White fill, <code>border-strong</code> 2px outline, <code>text-link</code> label, radius <code>md</code>	For other actions next to a primary button
Coral button (campaign only)	<code>secondary-600</code> fill with white label	Use only for fundraising appeals, never next to error messages
Text link	<code>text-link</code> , always underlined	Visited links keep the underline

- Make every button at least 44px tall with at least 16px horizontal padding, so it is easy to tap for people with less steady hands.
- Write button labels as verbs in sentence case: "Find a food hub", not "Click here" or "Submit".
- Never use exact Sunset Coral or Tide Blue for button fills with white text or for link text. They fail contrast; use the 600 steps named in the pairings table in chapter 04.

Forms

- Every field has a visible label above it in `label` type. Placeholder text is never the only label.
- Field borders use `border-strong` (at least 3:1 against the page). Radius `sm`.
- Mark required fields with the word "(required)", not only an asterisk or colour.
- Errors: show the `error-fg` text with an error icon directly under the field, and an error summary at the top of the form that links to each field. Keep brand Sunset Coral out of error messages so people do not confuse a campaign colour with a problem.
- Ask only what you need. Explain why you ask for sensitive details such as income or housing situation, in plain English.
- Allow enough time, never expire a form without warning, and let people go back without losing what they typed.

Interactive states

State	Treatment
Hover	Darken the fill one step (for example <code>primary-700</code> on a <code>surface-brand</code> button) or thicken the link underline
Focus	The focus ring from chapter 13: <code>focus</code> colour on light backgrounds; white ring (<code>focus-on-brand</code>) inside Harbour Blue sections; <code>neutral-950</code> ring inside Sunset Coral and Tide Blue sections. Never removed
Active / pressed	One step darker again, with no movement for reduced-motion users
Disabled	Lower contrast plus a reason in text ("Choose a date first"). Avoid disabled buttons where you can: let people press and explain what is missing
Selected	A tick icon or bold label as well as colour

Accessibility State is never shown by colour alone. Pair every colour change with an underline, outline, icon or text.

Favicons and app icons

The favicons use the circular sun-and-waves symbol cropped from the master logo. The 16px and 32px icons sit on a transparent background; the Apple touch icon and maskable icon sit on a Harbour Blue square so the circle keeps a clear edge when a phone crops it to a rounded shape. At 16px the waves blur into texture, which is expected: the circle and coral sun still make the icon recognisable.



App/browser icon 48x48



App/browser icon
192x192



Apple touch icon
180x180 (opaque)



Android maskable icon
512x512 (content inside
safe circle)

```
<link rel="icon" href="/favicon.ico" sizes="48x48">
<link rel="icon" href="/icon-192.png" type="image/png" sizes="192x192">
<link rel="apple-touch-icon" href="/apple-touch-icon.png">
<link rel="manifest" href="/site.webmanifest">
<meta name="theme-color" content="#1d4e89">
```

- Copy the `<head>` snippet from `assets/favicons/head-snippet.html` into every page template, and publish `site.webmanifest` alongside it.
- The maskable icon keeps the symbol inside the central safe zone (the middle 80%). Do not enlarge it to fill the square; Android masks will cut the circle.
- Check the 16px favicon on both light and dark browser tabs before launch.

Open Graph and share images

Use the 1200 × 630px share image from the social kit (chapter 15) as the default `og:image`: the single-colour light logo centred on Harbour Blue. For campaign pages, make a version with a short headline in Nunito on a solid Harbour Blue panel. Keep the headline to eight words or fewer and inside the central safe area, because platforms crop the edges. Always set `og:image:alt` to describe the image, for example "Harbourside Community Trust logo on a blue background".

Email newsletters

Spec	Rule
Width	600px single column
Body text	body size (16px), never below 14px, line height 1.5, Arial or Verdana as the email-safe fallback for Atkinson Hyperlegible Next
Headings	Live text in Nunito with Arial fallback, never images of text
Buttons	Bulletproof (HTML) buttons, at least 44px tall, surface-brand fill
Logo	Full-colour PNG at 2× resolution, displayed 200px wide, on a white plate with clear space baked in
Images	Every image has alt text; decorative ones have empty alt. The email must make sense with images off

- **Dark mode:** many mail apps invert backgrounds. Because Harbour Blue fails on dark backgrounds, send the logo as a PNG with its own white rounded panel (radius 16px) rather than a transparent PNG. It then stays legible in both modes.
- Use plain-English subject lines. Put the key action in the first two sentences.
- Include a plain-text version, a "view in browser" link and a clear unsubscribe link.
- Offer translated summaries for families who read English as a second language, and say which languages are available.

Email signatures

Use one signature for all staff and regular volunteers:

1. Name (bold), optional pronouns
 2. Role, and "Volunteer" if relevant
 3. Harbourside Community Trust
 4. Phone number, and working days if part-time
 5. Website address as live text
 6. "[Registered charity number]" in 14px text
- The logo is optional. If used, it is the full-colour PNG at 2×, displayed no wider than 200px and never below the 160px minimum, with alt text "Harbourside Community Trust". A text-only signature is always acceptable.
 - No image-only signatures, inspirational quotes, coloured backgrounds or extra fonts. A campaign banner is allowed only when the Communications team supplies it, with alt text, for a set period.

Don't paste a screenshot of your signature. Screen readers cannot read it and it breaks in dark mode.

Video and webinars

- **Title cards:** the single-colour light logo on Harbour Blue, or full colour on white, held for at least 2 seconds.
- **Lower thirds:** name in Nunito bold, role in Atkinson Hyperlegible Next, white text on a solid Harbour Blue panel with radius `md`. Keep them on screen for at least 4 seconds and inside the 90% title-safe area.
- **Captions:** accurate, human-checked captions on every video, burned in for social and as a `.vtt` or `.srt` file on the website. Use white text on a dark semi-opaque box, sentence case, at least 2 lines at a size readable on a phone.
- **End cards:** the logo, one call to action, and the website address as text, held for at least 5 seconds.
- **Thumbnails:** a real face or scene plus a short headline on a solid panel. No text over busy photos.
- **Webinars:** use the 16:9 slide template from chapter 17, turn on live captions, share slides beforehand and record with a transcript.

Do describe key visual information out loud in videos and webinars, so people with sight loss do not miss it.

Don't autoplay video with sound on our website or in emails.

Social media

Social media is often the first place a family looks for a warm meal tonight, and the first place a donor checks whether we are trustworthy. Every post should be easy to read, easy to act on and safe for the people in it. That includes people using a screen reader, reading in their second language or looking at an old phone with the sound off.

This chapter is for anyone who posts, replies or designs for Harbourside Community Trust. The Communications team owns it. Send questions to comms@harbourside.example.

Channels and purpose

We use four social channels and one website-sharing format. Each one has a clear job. Posting frequencies are guidance for planning. They are not promises to our audience.

Channel	What it is for	Main audiences	Suggested rhythm
Facebook (Page, Events and community groups)	Service updates, opening times, events, community stories	Local families, older residents, volunteers	3–5 posts a week, plus events
Instagram	Stories of people and places (shared with consent), volunteer life, appeals	Younger families, volunteers, local supporters	2–4 feed posts a week, Stories as needed
WhatsApp Business (Channel and broadcast lists)	Short, practical updates: closures, food club times, volunteer rotas	Families and volunteers who have opted in	Only when there is something useful, at most 3 messages a week per list
LinkedIn (Company Page)	Impact, partnerships, corporate volunteering, jobs	Donors, council partners, local businesses	1–2 posts a week
Website sharing (Open Graph)	The preview image and text shown when someone shares a link to our website	Everyone	Set on every web page

Facebook matters most for older residents, so post every service change there first. WhatsApp reaches people who do not use other platforms, so keep every WhatsApp message useful.

Note Platform sizes and features change often. The table below was checked against official help pages on the review date shown in the specs. Check it again before a major campaign.

Specifications last reviewed 2026-10-02. Platform specifications change frequently. Verify against each platform's help centre before publishing and update this file and the style guide's review date. Sizes are recommended upload sizes in pixels; safe zones are approximate insets (fractions of width/height) kept clear of platform UI and cropping.

Image sizes by platform

Platform	Format	Size	Ratio	Safe zone	Notes
Instagram	Profile picture	320 × 320 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
Instagram	Feed post (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	
Instagram	Feed post (portrait 4:5)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5	8% margin	
Instagram	Feed post (portrait 3:4)	1080 × 1440 px	3:4	8% margin	Profile grid previews crop to 3:4; keep key content central.
Instagram	Story	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B14% L6%	
Instagram	Reel / cover	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B35% L6%	Reel cover is cropped to 1:1 on the profile grid and 3:4 in previews.
Facebook	Page profile picture	720 × 720 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
Facebook	Page cover	1640 × 624 px	2.63:1	inset T10% R18% B10% L18%	Displays at 820x312 on desktop and 640x360 on mobile; mobile crops about 17% from each side, so keep logos and text in the central 64%.

Platform	Format	Size	Ratio	Safe zone	Notes
Facebook	Feed post (4:5)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5	8% margin	
Facebook	Feed post (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	
Facebook	Link share image	1200 × 630 px	1.90:1	8% margin	
Facebook	Story	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B14% L6%	
Facebook	Event cover	1920 × 1005 px	1.91:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Company page logo	400 × 400 px	1:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Company page cover	1512 × 256 px	5.91:1	inset T10% R5% B10% L20%	Displays at about 1128x191; keep the same ~6:1 ratio. Logo overlaps the lower-left on some layouts. Sources disagree on upload size (1512x256 vs 4200x700); verify on LinkedIn's Page image specs.
LinkedIn	Employee profile banner	1584 × 396 px	4:1	inset T10% R5% B10% L30%	Profile photo overlaps the lower-left.

Platform	Format	Size	Ratio	Safe zone	Notes
LinkedIn	Post image (landscape)	1200 × 627 px	1.91:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Post image (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Post image (portrait 4:5)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5	8% margin	
WhatsApp Business	Business profile picture	640 × 640 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
WhatsApp Business	Status	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B14% L6%	
Website sharing (Open Graph)	Open Graph / social share image	1200 × 630 px	1.90:1	inset T8% R8% B8% L8%	

Accessibility features by platform

Platform	Image descriptions (alt text)	Video captions
Instagram	Supported: Advanced settings > Accessibility > Write alt text (feed posts).	Auto-captions available for Reels; review and correct them, or burn in reviewed open captions.
Facebook	Supported: Edit photo > Alternative text (overrides automatic alt text).	Upload an .srt caption file or use auto-generated captions, then review them.
LinkedIn	Supported: Alt text option when adding an image to a post.	Upload an .srt caption file with native video.
WhatsApp Business	Not supported for images; put essential information in the message text.	Burn in reviewed captions for video and status updates.
Website sharing (Open Graph)	Set og:image:alt and twitter:image:alt meta tags.	n/a

Handles and naming

No official handles have been confirmed yet. Until they are, use **[@handle — to be confirmed]** in drafts and templates.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: use one pattern everywhere, **HarboursideTrust**, so people can find us by guessing. Write it in CamelCase in print and captions (@HarboursideTrust). This helps screen readers and people reading in a second language. Before deciding, check that the name is free on every platform. If it is taken on one, add the same suffix everywhere (for example HarboursideTrustUK). Do not use a different name for each platform.

Item	Rule
Display name	"Harbourside Community Trust" in full, on every platform. No emoji or campaign words
Short bio (LinkedIn tagline limit is 120 characters)	"We help Harbourside families find safe homes, warm meals and good work. A local charity."
Long bio	The short bio, then opening hours or how to get help, then the website link
Charity details	<i>Proposed:</i> add "Registered charity no. [number — to be confirmed]" wherever the bio or page details allow
Link in bio	One link only, to a page on our own website that lists current help and appeals. Never use a third-party link page that tracks visitors
Verification	Apply for verification or a business badge where it is free and the platform offers it to charities. Never pay a third party for it

Sub-accounts. We do not open separate accounts for projects, places or teams. Post through the main accounts so families see one trusted source. A Facebook group (for example a volunteer group) must be named "Harbourside Community Trust – [Purpose]", link back to our Page and have at least two staff admins. A new account needs agreement from the Communications team.

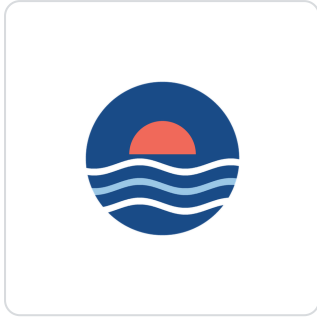
Do use the same name, avatar and bio pattern on every platform so people can tell the real account from a fake.

Don't let a project, volunteer or partner open an account using our name or logo.

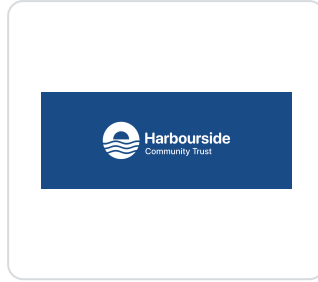
Profile and cover images

Our logo is wide, so it becomes unreadable in a small circle. Avatars use the **circular symbol only** (the sun over the waves) on a white background, which keeps the circle's edge visible. Covers use the full logo in white (knockout) on Harbour Blue.

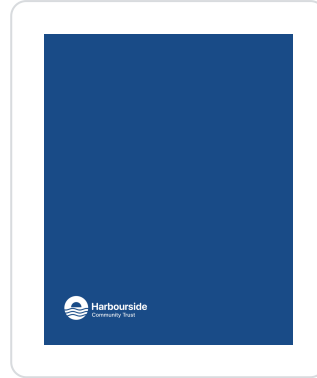
Facebook



Facebook Page profile picture (720x720) — Logo sized to sit inside the circular crop.



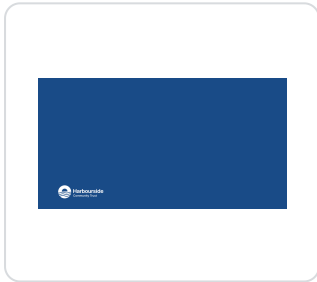
Facebook Page cover (1640x624) — Displays at 820x312 on desktop and 640x360 on mobile; mobile crops about 17% from each side, so keep logos and text in the central 64%.



Facebook Feed post (4:5) (1080x1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



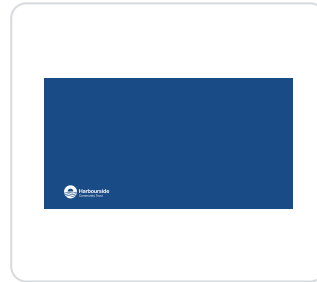
Facebook Feed post (square) (1080x1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



Facebook Link share image (1200x630) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template

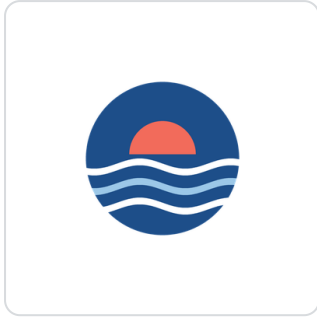


Facebook Story (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



Facebook Event cover (1920x1005) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template

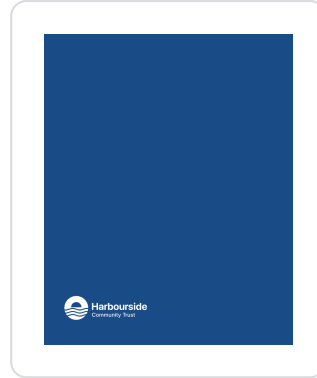
Instagram



Instagram Profile picture (320x320) — Logo sized to sit inside the circular crop.



Instagram Feed post (square) (1080x1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



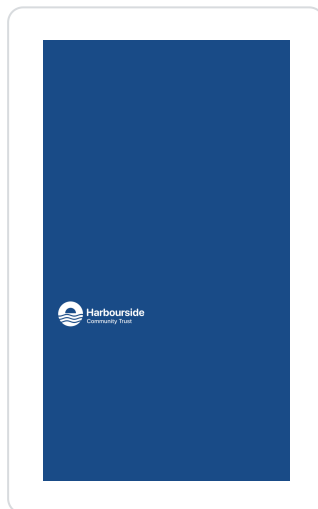
Instagram Feed post (portrait 4:5) (1080x1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



Instagram Feed post (portrait 3:4) (1080x1440) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template — Profile grid previews crop to 3:4; keep key content central.



Instagram Story (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



Instagram Reel / cover (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template — Reel cover is cropped to 1:1 on the profile grid and 3:4 in previews.

WhatsApp Business



WhatsApp Business
Business profile picture
(640x640) — Logo sized
to sit inside the circular
crop.



WhatsApp Business
Status (1080x1920)
layout preview; add the
headline using the SVG
template

LinkedIn



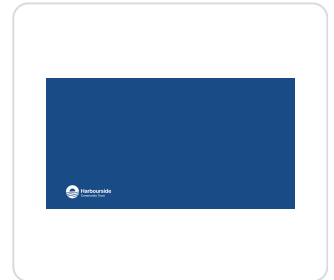
LinkedIn Company page
logo (400x400)



LinkedIn Company page
cover (1512x256) —
Displays at about
1128x191; keep the same
~6:1 ratio. Logo overlaps
the lower-left on some
layouts. Sources disagree
on upload size (1512x256
vs 4200x700); verify on
LinkedIn's Page image
specs.



LinkedIn Employee
profile banner
(1584x396) — Profile
photo overlaps the lower-
left.



LinkedIn Post image
(landscape) (1200x627)
layout preview; add the
headline using the SVG
template

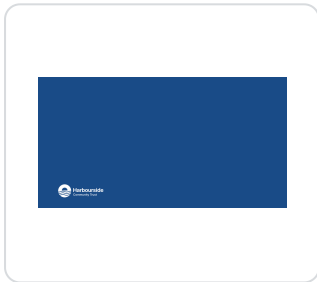


LinkedIn Post image (square) (1080x1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



LinkedIn Post image (portrait 4:5) (1080x1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template

Website sharing (Open Graph)



Website sharing (Open Graph) Open Graph / social share image (1200x630) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template

Each format also has an editable SVG template (with a hideable `guides` layer) and a `-guides.svg` safe-zone overlay in the same folder.

- **Avatar:** use the avatar PNG for each platform exactly as supplied. It is already sized to fit inside the circular crop. Do not add a frame, ribbon or campaign badge.
- **Covers:** use the cover template. Keep text and the logo inside the dashed safe zone (the `guides` layer, which you hide before export). On Facebook, phones crop about a sixth from each side of the cover. Keep words and the logo in the middle two-thirds.
- **LinkedIn cover:** keep it simple, using the logo plus at most one short line. The cover displays at about 191 pixels high, so a second line becomes too small to read.
- **Campaigns:** you may change the cover for a campaign for up to eight weeks, then change it back. The avatar never changes.
- **Open Graph image:** every web page needs a share image (1200 × 630) with `og:image:alt` set. Keep text inside the 8% safe margin.

Warning The symbol was cropped from the master PNG. A designer must confirm it, or supply vector artwork, before the avatars are used on live accounts.

Post design

Templates for every format are in `assets/social/<platform>/`. Each format has an editable SVG with a `guides` layer, which you must hide before export, and a safe-zone overlay. Start from a template every time.

Warning In this first version of the kit, the generated templates need three fixes before use. The supporting line on post templates is too small: set it to at least 4% of the image height (54px on a 1080 × 1350 post) in Atkinson Hyperlegible Next, and keep the headline short enough to stay inside the safe zone. On the Facebook cover, keep text at least 17% in from each side, because phones crop the edges. On the LinkedIn cover, remove the supporting line. Also note that the PNG previews centre the logo, but the SVG templates place it bottom-left. Follow the SVG templates.

Layout and the logo

- Place the full-colour or white logo in the **bottom-left corner, inside the safe zone**. It should be about a quarter of the image width and never less than 160px wide. On Stories, Reels and WhatsApp Status, keep it above the bottom safe zone, because the reply bar covers the bottom edge.
- On Reels, the bottom 35% is covered by captions and buttons. Keep all text and the logo above it.
- Use one logo per post. On a photo, use the white logo on a Harbour Blue band rather than straight on a busy image.

Text on images

- At most **20 words** on an image. If you need more, put it in the caption.
- Make text **at least 4% of the image height** (54px on a 1080 × 1350 post). Headlines use Nunito Bold or ExtraBold. Supporting text uses Atkinson Hyperlegible Next.
- Left-align text. Use sentence case, not capitals.
- Repeat every word from the image in the caption or alt text.

Colour on posts

The colour pairings below have been checked against our contrast rules.

Use	Pairing	Contrast
Default post	White text on Harbour Blue (primary)	8.4:1
Light post	Harbour Blue text on white or primary-100	8.4:1 / 7.1:1
Warm highlight panel	White text on secondary-600	5.8:1
Sunset Coral panel	Near-black (neutral-950) text on Sunset Coral	6.5:1

Sunset Coral and Tide Blue are for shapes, waves and decoration. Never use Sunset Coral text on Harbour Blue or on white, because both fail (2.84:1 and 2.95:1).

Carousels

Use the same cover design on every carousel. Number the slides ("2 of 5") in the bottom-right corner. End with one clear call to action, such as "Find your nearest food club: link in bio." Use no more than 10 slides.

Video

- Use a brand intro of no more than 2 seconds, or none at all, because people scroll past slow starts. Keep the outro end card to 5 seconds or less, with one call to action.
- **Lower thirds:** a Harbour Blue bar with the person's first name and role in white Atkinson Hyperlegible Next. Use a first name only, and only with consent.
- **Burned-in captions:** white Atkinson Hyperlegible Next on a near-black box (neutral-950 at 80% or more opacity). Use at most 2 lines of about 40 characters, placed above the platform's bottom safe zone.

Do start from the template, check the safe zone, then hide the guides layer before export.

Don't stretch, recolour or add effects to the logo, or put text on a photo without a solid panel behind it.

Content pillars

Most of what we post should help someone do something today.

Pillar	Purpose	Share
Help near you	Opening times, services, how to get help, changes to services	30%
Local stories	Stories of families, volunteers and neighbours, shared with written consent	25%
Get involved	Volunteering, events and rotas	20%
Fund our work	Appeals, donor thanks and what donations pay for	15%
Working together	Partners, council work, impact figures and jobs (mainly on LinkedIn)	10%

Writing for social

Follow chapter 11, Voice and tone: kind, plain and local. Social posts are casual. Replies to complaints are serious and kind.

- **Plain English for everyone.** Many readers speak English as a second language, and many are older. Use short sentences, common words and no idioms or slang. Write numbers as digits and dates in full ("Tuesday 4 November").
- **Structure:** start with a hook in the first 125 characters, because most platforms cut the post off there. Then make the point. End with one call to action, then any hashtags.
- **Length:** Facebook and LinkedIn posts are under 100 words. Instagram captions are under 150 words. WhatsApp messages are under 60 words, with the most important fact first.
- **Links:** say where a link goes ("Book a place on our website: [link]"). Never write "click here". Avoid unexplained short links.
- **Mentions and tagging:** tag partners only when they took part and have agreed. Never tag or name a person who receives our help.
- **Translated posts:** for safety-critical updates (closures, flooding, food club changes), publish translations as separate posts or messages. Start each one with the language name written in that language. Use a professional translator or a trained community volunteer to check every translation. Do not rely only on machine translation. Never put translated text only inside an image. *Proposed* — *confirm with frontline teams:* the main community languages to translate into.

Hashtags

- Write every hashtag in **CamelCase** (#HarboursideTrust , not #harboursidetrust) so screen readers say the words correctly.
- Put hashtags **at the end** of the post, never in the middle of a sentence.
- Use **no more than 3 hashtags** per post on any platform. On Facebook use 0–1, on Instagram and LinkedIn 2–3, and on WhatsApp none.
- *Proposed brand hashtags:* #HereForHarbourside (our proposed tagline) and #HarboursideTrust . Check that nobody else is using them before launch.
- Before using a campaign or awareness-day hashtag, check what else it is being used for.

Emoji

Use emoji to add warmth, not meaning. Our approved set is red heart (thanks), waving hand (welcome), house (homes), steaming bowl (meals), handshake (partners), calendar (dates) and sun (good news). Screen readers read each one aloud by name.

- Use **at most 2 emoji** per post, at the end of a sentence, never in place of a word.
- Never repeat an emoji in a row, and never put emoji in display names or handles.
- **No emoji** in crisis posts, safety updates, complaint replies or anything about hardship.

Accessibility on social

This section is mandatory. A post that fails it is not ready to publish.

- **Alt text on every image.** Describe what the image shows and why it matters, in about 125 characters. For an infographic, use longer alt text and link to a text version. Never start with "Image of".
- **WhatsApp has no alt text.** Put all the essential information in the message text, never only in the image.
- **Captions on every video.** Check and correct auto-captions before publishing. Add a transcript for videos longer than 1 minute. Make sure videos make sense with the sound off.
- **Hashtags in CamelCase**, with emoji limited as above.
- **No Unicode "fonts".** Never use fake bold or italic letters from text-generator websites. Screen readers read them as symbols or skip them.
- **Text in images is repeated** in the caption or alt text.
- **Contrast:** at least 4.5:1 for text on graphics, or 3:1 for very large headlines. Use the pairings in the post design section.
- **No flashing** of more than 3 flashes a second. Avoid fast cuts and strobe effects.
- **Plain language:** spell out acronyms and make links descriptive.

Accessibility features by platform

Platform	Alt text	Video captions
Facebook	Edit photo, then Alternative text (replaces the automatic alt text)	Upload an .srt file, or use auto-captions and then correct them
Instagram	Advanced settings, then Accessibility, then Write alt text (feed posts)	Auto-captions on Reels, which you must correct, or burned-in captions
LinkedIn	Use the Alt text option when adding an image	Upload an .srt file with native video
WhatsApp Business	Not available, so put the information in the message text	Burn in captions you have checked
Website sharing (Open Graph)	Set the <code>og:image:alt</code> and <code>twitter:image:alt</code> tags	Not applicable

Accessibility Our audience includes many older residents and people reading in their second language. Large, high-contrast text, plain words and full information in the caption help everyone.

Safeguarding, consent and privacy

The people we help can be vulnerable. Protecting them matters more than any post.

- **Written consent is required** before posting any photo, video or story of a person. Use the Trust's photo consent form, and keep it linked to the image. For children under 18, a parent or guardian must sign. Consent can be withdrawn at any time. Remove the content within 2 working days if it is.
- **Never identify a person receiving help** without their written consent, by name, face, voice, home, school or anything else that could identify them. If you are unsure, use photos of hands, places or volunteers instead.
- **Never share the location of vulnerable people**, such as a home, a temporary housing address or a refuge. Turn off geotagging. Post event photos after people have left.
- **Never ask for personal details in public.** Move the conversation to a private message.

WhatsApp: consent and privacy

- Use the **WhatsApp Channel** or **broadcast lists** for families. Use them instead of groups, because groups show every member's phone number to the others.
- Add people only after they **opt in**, and record when they did and how. Every broadcast message ends with: "Reply STOP to stop these messages." Remove anyone who replies STOP the same working day.

- Volunteer groups are allowed only with each member's agreement. Set them so that only admins can post, and include at least two staff admins.
- Never share personal details, case information or photos of service users on WhatsApp.

Community management

We reply as a person from the Trust: kind, clear and brief. Sign replies with a first name if the team agrees to that.

Situation	Response time (working hours, guidance)	What to do
Someone asks for help in a comment or message	Within 1 working day	Reply kindly, move to a private message, and signpost to the right service. Never assess need on social media
Someone may be in immediate danger	As soon as seen	Tell them to call 999. Alert the duty manager and follow the safeguarding policy
General question	Within 1 working day	Answer, or link to the right web page
Complaint	Acknowledge within 4 working hours	Say sorry where we got it wrong, take it to a private message, and follow up publicly once it is resolved
Wrong information about us	Same working day	Correct it calmly, with a source
Abuse, hate, harassment, scams	As soon as seen	Hide or remove, report to the platform and log a screenshot. Do not reply

- **Out of hours:** set an automatic reply on Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp. It should give our opening hours and say: "If you or someone else is in danger, call 999."
- **Escalation:** the team member handles it first. If unsure, go to the Communications lead, then the chief executive. Safeguarding concerns go straight to the safeguarding lead.
- **Moderation rules:** pin the house rules in Facebook groups. We remove abuse, discrimination, personal information, spam and scams. We do not remove criticism that is polite.

Crisis and sensitive moments

Storms, flooding, service closures, a data breach or negative press all need a fast, calm and accurate response.

1. **Pause** all scheduled posts on every channel straight away. Anyone on the team can do this.

2. **Confirm the facts** with the duty manager. Do not guess about causes or blame.
3. **Post a holding statement** within 1 hour if families are affected, after the Communications lead approves it. For example: "Our [service] at [place] is closed today because of [flooding]. Your nearest open point is [place, time]. We will update you here by [time]."
4. **Get approval:** the Communications lead approves service updates. The chief executive approves anything about safety, reputation or the media. For a data breach, the data protection lead decides whether to report it to the ICO, which must happen within 72 hours for breaches that have to be reported. Post nothing about a breach until the data protection lead and the chief executive approve it.
5. **Update** at the times you promised, on Facebook and WhatsApp first, in plain English and the agreed translations.
6. **Stay silent** about tragedies that have nothing to do with us. Do not post promotional or upbeat content during a local emergency.

Staff and volunteer advocacy

We welcome staff and volunteers sharing our work.

- Share official posts, and add your own words in your own voice.
- Say you work or volunteer for us when you post about us. On LinkedIn, the personal banner template (in `assets/social/linkedin/`) is available for staff.
- Your personal account is yours. Do not speak for the Trust, reply to complaints or make promises about services.
- Never post photos, names or stories of people we help from a personal account. Never give advice about someone's case. Signpost them to our official channels.

Fundraising appeals

Our appeals follow the Fundraising Regulator's Code of Fundraising Practice. Fundraising must be legal, open, honest and respectful.

- Say clearly what the money is for, and use only real, checked figures. When a figure shows only an example ("£10 could pay for..."), say so.
- Do not pressure people, use guilt, or target people who may be in vulnerable circumstances.
- Use real stories only with written consent. Never exaggerate need.
- The Communications lead must check every fundraising post.

Partners, influencers and user-generated content

- **Disclosure:** if a business pays, gifts or rewards someone to post about us, the post must say so clearly at the start. Use `#Ad` or the platform's paid-partnership label, following the UK ASA/CAP advertising rules. Ask for a legal check if you are unsure.
- **Co-branded posts:** follow chapter 19, Co-branding and partnerships. Our logo and the partner's logo should be the same visual size, inside the safe zone.
- **Reposting user content:** ask the owner for permission in writing (a message is fine) and credit them by handle. Never repost an image showing a child or a person we help, even with the owner's permission, unless we also hold our own written consent.

Governance and account security

Item	Rule
Owner	Communications team
Who can post	Communications team (admins). Named, trained staff (editors) can schedule posts. Volunteers never hold admin access
Approvals	Routine posts need one person. A second person must check posts that show people, ask for money or name a partner. Crisis posts follow the crisis steps
Security	Two-factor authentication on every account. Store logins in the Trust's password manager, never in personal accounts. At least two admins on every account
Offboarding	Remove access on the day someone leaves. Review the admin list every 3 months
Records	Keep a register of all official accounts, owners and recovery details. Keep consent forms with their images. Log every crisis post and every comment removed
Privacy	No personal data in posts or public replies. Follow the Trust's data protection and safeguarding policies

Social media: do and don't

Do write alt text, captions and plain-English copy for every post, every time.

Do move every request for help into a private message and signpost it within 1 working day.

Don't post a person's photo or story without signed consent, or reveal where a vulnerable person lives.

Don't use fake Unicode bold, more than 3 hashtags, or more than 2 emoji.

Pre-publish checklist

- [] **Brand:** made from a template, logo bottom-left inside the safe zone, approved colour pairing, brand fonts
- [] **Accessibility:** alt text added (or all information in the text on WhatsApp), captions checked, CamelCase hashtags at the end, no more than 2 emoji, no Unicode fonts, text in images repeated
- [] **Safeguarding and legal:** written consent on file, no one we help identified without it, no locations of vulnerable people, #Ad where needed, fundraising claims checked

- [] **Proof-read:** names, dates, times, place names and links tested. Read it aloud once

Print and stationery

Printed leaflets, letters and posters reach people who do not use the internet, including many older residents. Print must be easy to read in a dim community hall or on a doorstep, look warm and trustworthy, and reproduce our colours consistently from one printer to the next.

Warning We only have the logo as a PNG. Before any professional print job, ask the Communications team for vector artwork (PDF, EPS or SVG). Until a designer supplies it, the PNG may be used only for office printing at the size it was supplied or smaller.

Accessible print: our baseline

These rules apply to everything we print for the public:

- Body text at least 14pt in Atkinson Hyperlegible Next (or Verdana or Arial if the brand fonts are not installed). Captions, footers and legal lines at least 10pt; only business cards go smaller (see below).
- Offer a large-print version (16–18pt body) of every letter, leaflet and form on request, and say so on the item: "Need this in large print, another language or another format? Call [Phone number] or email comms@harbourside.example."
- Use dark text on white or a very light tint. Body text is `text-default` (neutral-900). Headings can be Harbour Blue.
- Never set text over a photo or pattern. Put text on a solid panel.
- Left-align text with a ragged right edge. No justified text, no long passages in capitals or italics.
- Print on matt or silk paper, never gloss, to cut glare for people with low vision.
- Keep at least 90gsm paper for letters so text does not show through.
- Pair every QR code with a short web address written out in full, and a phone number.

Do use plain English and short sentences, with one idea per paragraph, and lists for steps.

Don't print grey text on coloured paper, or print Sunset Coral or Tide Blue text. Use `secondary-600` if a coral heading is essential.

Business cards

Spec	Rule
Size	85 × 55mm, 3mm bleed, 4mm safe margin
Stock	Matt, at least 350gsm, ideally recycled or FSC certified
Front	Full-colour logo on white, at least 40mm wide, top left
Back (optional)	Harbour Blue flood with the single-colour light symbol centred
Text	Name 11pt bold, role and contact details at least 9pt; legal text never below 8pt

Information order: name, role, phone, email, website, then "[Registered charity number]".

Letterhead and letters to families

- A4, margins at least 20mm. Logo top left, 50–60mm wide, with its clear space.
- Footer: "[Registered address]", "[Registered charity number]", phone, email and website in 10pt text-muted.
- Use the Word template (chapter 17) rather than pre-printed paper, so letters can be made in large print or translated without reprinting stock.
- Letters to families use 14pt body text, a clear heading saying what the letter is about, and a "What to do next" box near the top on surface-subtle.
- For translated letters, keep the layout and the logo the same and add an English line naming the language and how to get help.

Envelopes and compliment slips

Item	Size	Rules
DL envelope	110 × 220mm	Logo top left on the back flap or front, 40mm wide; respect Royal Mail address and window zones
C5 envelope	162 × 229mm	As DL
C4 envelope	229 × 324mm	For reports and large-print packs
Compliment slip	99 × 210mm	Logo top left at 40–50mm, address line at the foot

Use a plain return address ("If undelivered, please return to [Registered address]"). Avoid messages on the outside that reveal a family's situation, such as "Food bank" or "Housing support", to protect their privacy.

Leaflets, flyers and posters

- **Sizes:** A5 and DL for leaflets, A4 and A3 for posters in community venues.
- **Grid:** 6 columns for A4 and A3, 4 columns for A5. Margins at least 10mm on leaflets, 15mm on posters.
- **Bleed and safe area:** 3mm bleed on every edge, and keep text and the logo at least 5mm inside the trim.
- **Logo:** at least 40mm wide; top left or bottom centre, in the same place on every item in a campaign.
- **Hierarchy:** one headline (Nunito bold), one image, three or four short points, one call to action with a phone number. Posters must be readable from 2m: headlines at least 72pt on A3, body at least 24pt.
- **Colour:** follow the 60/25/10/5 proportions from chapter 04. A Harbour Blue or Sunset Coral band works well for headers; text on Sunset Coral must be neutral-950, never white.
- **Images:** 300ppi at final size, in CMYK, with photographs that follow chapter 08.

Print colour and proofing

- Use the CMYK values in chapter 04 as a starting point only. They are mathematical conversions and must be checked with the printer.
- Pantone references are to be matched from a physical Pantone swatch book. Coated (C) and uncoated (U) papers give visibly different results, so choose a match for each stock you use.
- Always ask for a printed proof on the final paper for any new item or new printer. Check Harbour Blue does not drift towards purple and Sunset Coral does not turn orange.
- Use 100% black (K) for small text; ask the printer for their rich black only for large dark areas.
- Reversed text (white on Harbour Blue) must be at least 10pt and regular weight or heavier, so it does not fill in on uncoated paper.

Working with printers

Send print-ready PDFs (PDF/X-4) with fonts embedded, 3mm bleed and crop marks. Ask the Communications team (comms@harbourside.example) to approve every proof before it goes to press, and allow at least 5 working days for approval and proofing.

Presentations and documents

Slides, reports and letters are where our partners, funders and families judge whether we are organised and trustworthy. They are also where accessibility most often breaks: a report that cannot be read by a screen reader, or a letter that cannot be enlarged, shuts people out. Use the templates and styles below so every document is on-brand and accessible by default.

Templates we provide

The Communications team keeps these templates in the shared brand folder (see chapter 20):

Template	Format	Use for
Presentation	PowerPoint (.potx) and Google Slides, 16:9	Talks, partner meetings, volunteer training, webinars
Report	Word (.dotx) and Google Docs, A4	Annual and impact reports, reports to council partners and funders
Letter	Word (.dotx), A4	Letters to families, partners and supporters
Large-print letter	Word (.dotx), A4, 16pt body	Letters on request, and by default for known large-print readers
Policy	Word (.dotx), A4	Policies, procedures and volunteer handbooks
Proposal	Word (.dotx), A4	Funding bids and partnership proposals

Proposed — confirm with the Communications team: the templates still need building from these rules, and will need vector logo artwork for sharp print output.

Slide layouts

Every presentation template contains these master layouts. Always start from a layout; never draw free text boxes on a blank slide.

Layout	What it contains
Title	Full-colour logo on white, top left at least 160px wide; title in Nunito bold; presenter and date
Section	Harbour Blue background, single-colour light symbol, section title in white
Content	Title plus one text placeholder for up to 5 short points
Two-column	Title plus two placeholders, for comparisons or text with an image
Image	Full-bleed photo with a caption on a solid white or Harbour Blue panel
Quote	A quote from a family member or volunteer (with consent), name and role
Data	Title, one chart following chapter 09, and a one-line takeaway
End	Logo, one call to action, website, phone and "[Registered charity number]"

Slide rules

- 16:9 at 1920 × 1080px. Keep text and logos inside a safe area 64px from every edge.
- Slide text at least 24pt; titles 36–44pt. If your words do not fit at 24pt, split the slide.
- One idea per slide, and no more than 40 words of body text.
- Fonts: Nunito for titles and Atkinson Hyperlegible Next for text. If they are not installed, the template falls back to Arial (titles) and Verdana (text). Do not substitute other fonts.
- Colour: white or surface-subtle backgrounds for content slides; Harbour Blue for section slides. Text on Sunset Coral is neutral-950, never white.
- Logo: on the title and end slides only, plus the small symbol bottom right of content slides at 24px or larger. Not on every corner of every slide.

Do give every slide a unique title, even if you hide it visually, so people using a screen reader can navigate.

Don't put text inside images or screenshots of tables. Recreate them as live text or a real table.

Accessible slides

1. Use layout placeholders so the reading order is correct. Check it in the Selection Pane (PowerPoint) or by tabbing through (Google Slides).
2. Add alt text to every meaningful image, chart and icon. Mark decorative images as decorative.
3. Write link text that makes sense out of context ("Volunteer handbook (PDF, 2MB)").
4. Avoid animations and transitions other than a simple fade.

- 5. Run the built-in accessibility checker (PowerPoint: Review > Check Accessibility) before you share or present.
- 6. Share the slides before the session, in the original format and as a tagged PDF.

Documents: use real styles

Screen readers, translation tools and large-print conversion all rely on styles. Never fake a heading by making text bigger or bold.

Style	Font and size (Word)	Use
Title	Nunito bold 28pt, Harbour Blue	Once, on the cover
Heading 1	Nunito bold 20pt, Harbour Blue	Main sections
Heading 2	Nunito bold 16pt, neutral-900	Sub-sections
Heading 3	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next bold 14pt	Minor headings
Normal	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next 12pt, line spacing 1.5	Partner and internal reports
Normal (public)	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next 14pt, line spacing 1.5	Letters and documents for families
Caption	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next 11pt, text-muted	Figure and table captions

- Use Heading 1–3 in order with no skipped levels. Generate the contents from the headings.
- Use the built-in bulleted and numbered list styles.
- Tables: simple grids only, with a header row set to repeat on each page, no merged or empty cells used for layout.
- Left-align all text. No justified text and no text boxes for main content.
- Charts follow chapter 09 and have a short text summary beneath them.
- Set the document language (English (UK), or the translation's language) and the document title in File > Properties.

Accessibility Reports for council partners are often required to meet public-sector accessibility rules. Build them accessibly from the start; fixing a PDF afterwards is slow and unreliable.

Exporting to PDF

- Export from Word with "Document structure tags for accessibility" switched on, creating bookmarks from headings. In Google Docs, download as PDF and then check the tags; if they are missing, export via Word.

- The PDF must have a title, language set, tags, bookmarks for documents over 4 pages, and a logical reading order.
- Check every PDF with an accessibility checker (Adobe Acrobat's Accessibility Check, or the free PAC tool) before publishing.
- Always publish an accessible HTML page or Word version alongside a PDF on the website.
- For print, export a separate PDF/X-4 file following chapter 16.

File naming and version control

- Name files: `harbourside-[type]-[short-title]-[yyyy-mm-dd].[ext]` , for example `harbourside-report-winter-food-hubs-2026-11-30.pdf` . Lowercase, hyphens, no spaces.
- Add `-large-print` or a language code (for example `-pl` or `-ar`) for alternative versions.
- Keep one master in the shared drive. Mark drafts with `-draft-v1` , `-draft-v2` and remove the suffix only when approved.
- Record the owner and review date on the last page of policies and reports.

Do check a translated version with a fluent speaker from the community before it goes out.

Don't email large attachments to families; send a short message with a link, and offer a printed copy.

Signage, environment and merchandise

Signs, banners and volunteer clothing are how people find us in a church hall, a library or a busy street, and how they know who to ask for help. They must be easy to read from a distance and for people with sight loss, and make volunteers instantly recognisable without making anyone who uses our services feel singled out.

Warning Signs, banners, clothing and printed merchandise all need vector logo artwork. We only have a PNG today. Ask the Communications team (comms@harbourside.example) for vector files before ordering; no supplier should redraw or trace the logo themselves.

Signs at our hubs and venues

Most of our signs are temporary: A-boards, pull-up banners and laminated posters in venues we share. The same rules apply to permanent signs.

Rule	Specification
Typeface	Atkinson Hyperlegible Next bold for messages, Nunito bold for headlines. Sentence case, never all capitals
Letter size	About 25mm cap height for every 10m of viewing distance; at least 15mm for directional signs read close up
Logo size	At least 300mm wide for every 10m of viewing distance, so "Harbourside" stays readable
Contrast	Dark text on white, or white on Harbour Blue. Aim for a light reflectance value (LRV) difference of at least 70 points between text and background
Finish	Matt or satin, never gloss, so lights and sunshine do not cause glare
Wording	Short and positive: "Food hub open today, 10am to 2pm. Everyone welcome."

- Use the full-colour logo on white signs and the single-colour light logo on Harbour Blue signs.
- Put the key message, the opening times and a phone number on every hub sign. Add simple symbols for food, housing advice and work support, following the icon style in chapter 07.
- For permanent signs, follow current BS 8300 guidance and Approved Document M on contrast, mounting heights, tactile lettering and braille. Ask the venue owner, who is usually responsible for the building, before fixing anything.

Do test a new sign by reading it from the far end of the room, with reading glasses off.

Don't put signs on patterned walls or over posters. Mount them on a plain board with clear space around.

Wayfinding and safety

- Use standard pictograms (ISO 7001) for toilets, accessible toilets, baby changing, lifts and information. Do not redraw them in a brand style.
- Fire, first-aid and safety signs follow BS ISO 7010 and the venue's own signs. Never rebrand or recolour safety signs.
- Use arrows and words together ("Food hub, first floor" with an arrow), never arrows alone.

Glass doors and office branding

- Glass doors and screens need visible markings (manifestations) so people do not walk into them. In England, Approved Document K sets the heights; check the current edition. A row of Harbour Blue symbols, or a Harbour Blue band with the white symbol, works well. Do not use Tide Blue alone: it is too pale to be seen against a bright room behind the glass.
- Reception or entrance walls: the full-colour logo on a white or very light wall, at least 600mm wide, with the clear space from chapter 03. On a Harbour Blue wall, use the single-colour light logo.

Events

Item	Specification
Roll-up banner	850 × 2000mm. Logo in the top 400mm, message in the top 1200mm. Nothing important in the bottom 800mm, which tables and people hide
Table cover	Harbour Blue with the single-colour light logo centred on the front drop
Gazebo or flag	Single-colour light logo on Harbour Blue
Name badge	A6 or 100 × 70mm. First name at least 24pt bold, role ("Volunteer", "Staff") at least 14pt
Collection tin or bucket label	Full-colour logo on white, the full name in text and "[Registered charity number]"

- Add "I speak [Language]" badges for volunteers who speak community languages; they help families who speak English as a second language find someone to talk to.
- For street or house-to-house collections, check the council licence conditions before printing labels.

Volunteer clothing and lanyards

Item	Treatment
T-shirt or hoodie	Harbour Blue garment, single-colour light logo on the chest (at least 80mm wide) and "Volunteer" in large white type on the back
Hi-vis vest	Yellow or orange vest with the single-colour dark logo on the back, printed on a panel away from the reflective tape
Lanyard	Harbour Blue, 15–20mm wide, the white symbol repeated with "Harbourside Community Trust" as text, breakaway safety clasp
Apron (food hubs)	Harbour Blue or white, embroidered logo on the chest

- Lanyards are too narrow for the full logo at its 40mm minimum width, so use the symbol (at least 8mm) and the name as text.
- **Embroidery:** the thin white waves fill in when stitched small. Embroider the full logo at least 70mm wide and the symbol at least 25mm across; ask the embroiderer for a sew-out sample first. Match thread colours to Harbour Blue, Sunset Coral and white from the embroiderer's thread chart, against a printed proof. *Proposed — confirm with a designer.*
- Check with the hi-vis supplier that printing does not affect the garment's safety certification.
- Single-colour logos use the knockout style, so the garment colour shows through the sun and waves. Only use them on solid-colour fabric, never on patterned or camouflage fabrics.

Do keep clothing simple and the same for every volunteer, so families can spot who to ask.

Don't use Sunset Coral garments with a white logo; white on Sunset Coral is too low in contrast.

Merchandise and food parcels

- Choose useful, durable and sustainable items: cotton tote bags, reusable cups, pens made from recycled material. Avoid single-use plastic novelties.
- Print in one colour wherever possible: the single-colour light logo on Harbour Blue items, or the single-colour dark logo on light items. Full colour only on white.
- Respect the minimum sizes: the full logo at least 40mm wide, or the symbol at least 8mm with the name in text on very small items such as pens.
- **Food parcels and bags given to families:** keep branding discreet, such as a small symbol or a sticker inside. People should be able to carry their shopping home without advertising that they used a food bank.

Accessibility Merchandise is never the only way we share important information. Phone numbers and opening times always appear on leaflets and the website too.

Vehicles

If we use or borrow a van, apply the single-colour light logo on Harbour Blue panels, or full colour on a white vehicle, at least 600mm wide on each side, with the website address and phone number in text at least 75mm high. Get written agreement from the vehicle owner before applying any graphics.

Co-branding and partnerships

Almost everything we do happens together: with the council, other charities, local businesses and funders. Showing those relationships clearly and fairly builds trust with families and funders alike, and it reflects our value of working together. These rules make sure every partner is credited correctly and our logo stays legible next to theirs.

Types of relationship

Relationship	Example	Whose logo leads	How we show it
We lead, partners support	A Harbourside food hub run with a local church	Ours	Our logo first and largest; partner logos in a "With support from" row
Partner leads, we support	A council housing scheme we deliver part of	The partner's	Their logo first; ours in their supporter row, following their guidelines
Equal partnership	A joint project with another local charity	Shared	Logos side by side at equal optical size with a divider or "in partnership with"
Funder	A grant from "[Funder name]"	Ours	"Funded by" line and the funder's logo, using the funder's required wording
Sponsor	A local business sponsoring an event	Ours	"Sponsored by" line and the sponsor's logo, smaller than ours
Supplier	A printer or caterer	Ours only	Suppliers do not appear on our materials and may not use our logo without written permission

Lock-up rules

- **Optical size:** for equal partners, match the logos by visual weight, not by width. Our wide logo usually needs to be slightly wider than a square partner logo to look the same size.
- **Divider:** separate logos with a thin vertical line in `border-subtle`, or the words "in partnership with" in `small` type. The divider is as tall as the taller logo.
- **Spacing:** apply our clear space (the height of the sun in our symbol) on every side of the whole lock-up, and the same distance between each logo and the divider.

- **Order:** the lead organisation is first (left, or top in a stacked row). For equal partners, the host of the material goes first.
- **Alignment:** align logos on their vertical centres in a row. In a supporter row, keep every logo the same height and spaced evenly.
- **Minimum size:** our logo never goes below 160px or 40mm wide in a lock-up. If a supporter row would force it smaller, use fewer logos or move the row.

Backgrounds for shared lock-ups

- Put lock-ups on white whenever possible. Our full-colour logo is approved on white only.
- On Harbour Blue or other colours, use our single-colour light or dark logo and ask partners for their equivalent single-colour version.
- Never place partner logos on a busy photo. Use a solid white strip along the bottom of posters and leaflets for the logo row.

Do ask each partner for their latest logo files and brand guidelines. Their rules apply to their logo, just as ours apply to ours.

Don't recolour a partner's logo in Harbour Blue to make it "match", or put our logo inside a partner's shape or frame.

Funding and supporter lines

Many funders and the council require exact acknowledgement wording and logo placement as a condition of the grant. Check the grant agreement before designing anything.

- Use simple, consistent wording in `small` or `body` type above the logo row: "Funded by [Funder name]", "With support from [Partner name]", "Delivered in partnership with [Partner name]".
- On web pages, write the funder's name as text as well as showing the logo.
- On small items such as social posts, a text credit ("Funded by [Funder name]") is acceptable where the funder allows it.

Projects and sub-brands

We are one organisation with one logo. Projects such as "[Project name]" do not get their own logos or symbols, which would confuse families and dilute recognition.

- Name projects in plain words: "[Project name], a Harbourside Community Trust project".
- Set the project name in Nunito bold with the full Harbourside logo nearby, at its normal minimum size.
- If a partner-led project needs its own identity, the Communications team agrees it with the partner and records it in this guide.

Approvals and lead times

Item	Who approves	Allow
Any use of our logo by a partner, funder or sponsor	Communications team	5 working days
Co-branded print, signage or banners	Communications team and each partner	10 working days, plus the partner's own approval time
Press releases naming partners	Communications team and each partner	3 working days

Send requests to comms@harbourside.example with the draft, where it will be used and the deadline. We supply our logo files; partners must not copy them from our website.

Co-branding accessibility

- Both our logo and partner logos keep at least 3:1 contrast against the background behind them.
- Alt text names every organisation: "Logos of Harbourside Community Trust and [Partner name]". For a funder row: "Funded by [Funder name]".
- Never make the logo row the only place a partner or funder is credited in a document. Include them in the text too, so screen-reader users and anyone reading a plain-text version get the same information.

Legal, governance and assets

Our name and logo are how families, volunteers and funders know that something really comes from us. Clear rules on ownership, approvals and files protect that trust, and stop out-of-date or unofficial versions spreading.

Trademarks and our name

Proposed — confirm with leadership and a legal adviser: We have not confirmed whether the name or logo is a registered trade mark.

- Until registration is confirmed, **do not** use the ® symbol. Using ® for an unregistered mark is an offence in the UK.
- You may use ™ to show we claim the name and logo as our marks, but it is not needed on everyday materials. If used, place it once, on the first or most prominent use only.
- Always write our name in full as **Harbourside Community Trust** on first use. After that, *Harbourside Community Trust* or *the Trust* is fine. Do not shorten it to an acronym in public materials; acronyms are harder for readers with English as a second language.
- Never alter, abbreviate or add words to the logo.

Required legal lines

UK charities must state their registered status on many documents. Our details have not yet been supplied, so use these placeholders until the Communications team confirms them:

- **Charity status line:** *Harbourside Community Trust is a registered charity in England and Wales, number [Registered charity number].* *Proposed — confirm the correct regulator, jurisdiction and wording.*
- **Company line, if we are a charitable company:** *Registered in England and Wales, company number [Company number]. Registered office: [Address].*
- **Copyright line:** © [Year] Harbourside Community Trust. All rights reserved. Use the year of first publication.

Put these lines on the website footer, letterhead, invoices, fundraising materials, emails and annual reports. Set them in the `small` type style, never smaller.

Fonts, images and other licences

Asset	Licence	What it means for you
Nunito and Atkinson Hyperlegible Next	SIL Open Font License 1.1	Free to use in print, web, apps, social and video. You may not sell the font files on their own
JetBrains Mono	SIL Open Font License 1.1	As above
Photographs we commission	Agree in writing who owns the copyright and how we may use them	Get a written licence or assignment from the photographer before use
Stock photographs	The stock site's licence	Keep a record of the licence and source for every image
Photos and stories of people we help	Written, informed consent	Store consent forms securely, record the expiry date, and remove content when consent is withdrawn

Keep image and consent records in the shared asset library for at least as long as the image is in use. Our handling of personal data in stories must follow UK GDPR and our privacy notice.

Approvals workflow

1. **Everyday items** using an unchanged template (social posts, posters from templates, email signatures): the person making it checks it against this guide and the accessibility checklist. No sign-off needed.
2. **New designs** (new leaflets, campaigns, signage, merchandise): send a draft to the Communications team at comms@harbourside.example. Allow five working days.
3. **Co-branded items and anything with a partner's or funder's logo**: Communications team approval, plus the partner's own approval process.
4. **Fundraising appeals, press releases and statements on sensitive issues**: Communications team plus a senior manager.
5. **Printed items over [budget threshold] or large runs**: see a printer's proof before sign-off.

Do allow time for approval when planning a campaign or event.

Don't print or publish a new design that has not been approved, even if it looks close to the templates.

Brand ownership and contacts

Role	Responsibility	Contact
Brand owner: Communications team	Keeps the guide and asset kit up to date; approves new designs	comms@harbourside.example
Senior manager [Name to be confirmed]	Signs off appeals and sensitive statements	Via the Communications team
Trustees	Approve changes to mission, values and the logo	Via the Communications team

Asset library and file naming

The official files live in the asset kit that comes with this guide (listed below). Store a copy in our shared drive at **[shared drive location]** and always download from there, never from old emails or a website.

File names follow this pattern, in lower case with hyphens:

[item]-[variant]-[colour]-[size].[format]

For example, `primary-full-colour.png`, `primary-mono-light-knockout.svg` or `instagram-avatar-320x320.png`.

- Use **SVG** for websites and digital documents, **PNG** where SVG is not supported, and **vector PDF or EPS** for print once vector artwork is available.
- Our logo currently exists only as a PNG. Ask a designer to produce vector master artwork before large print, signage or merchandise.

Review and version history

We review this guide every 12 months, and after any rebrand, a new social platform, or a change in accessibility law. The Communications team keeps the version history.

Version	Date	Change
1.0.0	2 October 2026	First version of the Harbourside Community Trust brand style guide

Version numbers follow a simple rule: small fixes change the last number (1.0.1), new sections change the middle number (1.1.0), and a rebrand changes the first number (2.0.0).

Downloads

Logo files

- primary-original.png — Original logo file as supplied
- primary-full-colour.png — primary logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)
- primary-full-colour-clearspace.png — primary logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in
- primary-mono-dark.png — primary logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)
- primary-mono-dark-clearspace.png — primary logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in
- primary-mono-light.png — primary logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)
- primary-mono-light-clearspace.png — primary logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in
- primary-mono-dark-knockout.png — primary logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)
- primary-mono-dark-knockout-clearspace.png — primary logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- primary-mono-light-knockout.png — primary logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)
- primary-mono-light-knockout-clearspace.png — primary logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- symbol-full-colour.png — symbol logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)
- symbol-full-colour-clearspace.png — symbol logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in
- symbol-mono-dark.png — symbol logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)
- symbol-mono-dark-clearspace.png — symbol logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in
- symbol-mono-light.png — symbol logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)
- symbol-mono-light-clearspace.png — symbol logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in
- symbol-mono-dark-knockout.png — symbol logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)
- symbol-mono-dark-knockout-clearspace.png — symbol logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- symbol-mono-light-knockout.png — symbol logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)
- symbol-mono-light-knockout-clearspace.png — symbol logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- logo-on-white.png — Logo (full-colour) on white background
- logo-on-light-neutral.png — Logo (mono-dark) on light-neutral background
- logo-on-primary.png — Logo (mono-light) on primary background
- logo-on-dark.png — Logo (mono-light) on dark background
- logo-on-secondary.png — Logo (mono-dark) on secondary background
- logo-on-accent.png — Logo (mono-dark) on accent background

Favicons and app icons

- favicon.ico — Browser favicon (16, 32, 48 px) on a solid brand tile
- icon-16.png — App/browser icon 16x16
- icon-32.png — App/browser icon 32x32
- icon-48.png — App/browser icon 48x48
- icon-192.png — App/browser icon 192x192
- icon-512.png — App/browser icon 512x512
- apple-touch-icon.png — Apple touch icon 180x180 (opaque)
- icon-maskable-512.png — Android maskable icon 512x512 (content inside safe circle)

- site.webmanifest — Web app manifest
- head-snippet.html — HTML <head> tags for favicons

Social media kit

- facebook-avatar-720x720.svg — Editable template: Facebook Page profile picture
- facebook-avatar-720x720.png — Facebook Page profile picture (720x720)
- facebook-cover-1640x624.svg — Editable template: Facebook Page cover
- facebook-cover-1640x624.png — Facebook Page cover (1640x624)
- facebook-feed-portrait-1080x1350.svg — Editable template: Facebook Feed post (4:5)
- facebook-feed-portrait-1080x1350.png — Facebook Feed post (4:5) (1080x1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- facebook-feed-square-1080x1080.svg — Editable template: Facebook Feed post (square)
- facebook-feed-square-1080x1080.png — Facebook Feed post (square) (1080x1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- facebook-link-1200x630.svg — Editable template: Facebook Link share image
- facebook-link-1200x630.png — Facebook Link share image (1200x630) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- facebook-story-1080x1920.svg — Editable template: Facebook Story
- facebook-story-1080x1920.png — Facebook Story (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- facebook-event-1920x1005.svg — Editable template: Facebook Event cover
- facebook-event-1920x1005.png — Facebook Event cover (1920x1005) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- instagram-avatar-320x320.svg — Editable template: Instagram Profile picture
- instagram-avatar-320x320.png — Instagram Profile picture (320x320)
- instagram-feed-square-1080x1080.svg — Editable template: Instagram Feed post (square)
- instagram-feed-square-1080x1080.png — Instagram Feed post (square) (1080x1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- instagram-feed-portrait-1080x1350.svg — Editable template: Instagram Feed post (portrait 4:5)
- instagram-feed-portrait-1080x1350.png — Instagram Feed post (portrait 4:5) (1080x1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- instagram-feed-portrait-34-1080x1440.svg — Editable template: Instagram Feed post (portrait 3:4)
- instagram-feed-portrait-34-1080x1440.png — Instagram Feed post (portrait 3:4) (1080x1440) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- instagram-story-1080x1920.svg — Editable template: Instagram Story
- instagram-story-1080x1920.png — Instagram Story (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- instagram-reel-1080x1920.svg — Editable template: Instagram Reel / cover
- instagram-reel-1080x1920.png — Instagram Reel / cover (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- whatsapp-avatar-640x640.svg — Editable template: WhatsApp Business Business profile picture
- whatsapp-avatar-640x640.png — WhatsApp Business Business profile picture (640x640)
- whatsapp-status-1080x1920.svg — Editable template: WhatsApp Business Status
- whatsapp-status-1080x1920.png — WhatsApp Business Status (1080x1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- ...and 14 more in `assets/social/`

Design tokens

- _tokens.scss
- tailwind-theme.css
- tailwind.preset.js
- tokens.css
- tokens.json